

RESEARCH PACK AND APPLICATION GUIDE

Weatherbys Bank Private Banking Summer Internship 2027

The firm from the inside, the industry from zero, and how to write the three application answers

Employer: Weatherbys Bank Limited (trading as Weatherbys Private Bank), Co. no. 02943300, FRN 204571, registered office 52-60 Sanders Road, Wellingborough NN8 4BX

Role: 2027 Private Banking Summer Internship, Private Banking Clients, London, on-site, 5 July to 26 August 2027

Applications close: Friday 23 October 2026 | **Assessment centre:** Mon 30 November or Mon 7 December 2026 (subject to change)

Prepared: 7 October 2026, from public sources only. Every non-obvious fact carries a source tag [Sxx] resolved in Part 15.

Confidence tags used throughout: **Confirmed** primary source or two credible outlets **Reported** single credible source **Inferred** the author's reasoning

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What is in this pack

Page numbers are real. Part A is new compared with a standard interview pack because your next deadline is the application form, not an interview.

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SOURCE UNCERTAIN: READ THIS ONCE

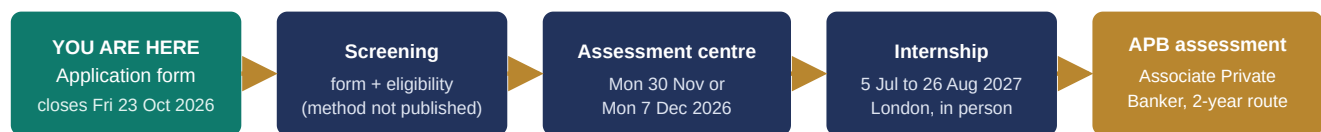
The template behind this pack asked for named interviewers, insider intelligence and your CV. None were supplied, so Part 10 covers the senior people you are most likely to meet (public professional facts only) and Part A uses [highlighted placeholders] where only your own story can go. Send your CV or draft answers and every placeholder can be filled.

PART 0

How to use this pack

Two deadlines matter. The form closes on Friday 23 October 2026 (16 days from today). The assessment centre follows on 30 November or 7 December.

Fig 0.1 The route from this form to a permanent job



Dates: the 2027 job advert (verbatim, supplied by you). APB = Associate Private Banker programme, "a fast-track route into qualifying as a Private Banker in two years" [S9]. Five APBs joined in 2025 [S4]. Screening method is not published: the "screening" box is an inference.

The 10-minute version

- What Weatherbys is.** A family-owned private bank founded on a 1770 racing business. It got its banking licence in 1994 and opened in London in 2006. In 2025 it had £1.9bn of deposits, £1.0bn of loans and 483 staff, and is aiming to "double in size over the next five years" [S4][S5] **Confirmed**.
- How it makes money.** It takes deposits from wealthy clients and lends out about half of them (a loan-to-deposit ratio of 53%). It earns the interest margin, plus a smaller amount in fees. When Bank Rate fell, its net interest margin fell from 4.53% to 4.05%, and underlying profit roughly halved, from £26.7m to £12.8m [S4] **Confirmed**.
- What makes it different.** Each client has a named banker who covers lending, investments and day-to-day banking. Lending decisions are made by people, not credit scores. It has specialist teams for farms and estates, racing, sport and entertainment, and law-firm partners. Its client satisfaction score (Net Promoter Score) is 84, and the CEO says he leaves "as much judgement and discretion with the front line as I possibly can" [S4][S15][S17].
- What is happening.** It is hiring bankers from Coutts. It won Citywealth "Private Bank of the Year" in May 2026, launched a Business Bank in late 2025, sold its insurance stake in August 2025, and extended Lombard lending to portfolios held at other firms in August 2026 [S4][S26][S27][S31].
- What is happening to its clients.** Since 6 April 2026, farms and family businesses get full inheritance tax relief only on the first £2.5m. Pensions come into inheritance tax from 6 April 2027. Bank Rate is 3.75%, and three of the nine Bank of England rate-setters voted to raise it in September [S152][S154][S102].
- The application.** The form has three questions. Q1 tests motivation and research, Q2 tests relationship-building (the core skill of the job) and Q3 tests what you are like outside your degree. Weatherbys publishes no weighting. Plan on roughly **30 / 40 / 30** effort, for the reasons in Part A.
- The one line to remember.** "Weatherbys is built so that one person who knows the client makes the decision. I want to learn to be that person."

READ FIRST, GIVEN THE DEADLINE

1) Part A (the form), all of it. 2) Part 2, pages on the money and the client segments, so your Q1 answer contains real mechanism. 3) Part 12, the "why Weatherbys" builder. The assessment-centre parts (9 to 11) can wait until November.

PART A

The application form

Three questions, 800 words in total. This part covers how they are probably weighted, what each one tests, what a stand-out answer does, and a draft frame for each with placeholders for your own story.

A1. Is there an official weighting?

No. Weatherbys does not publish how the form is scored. Its careers pages and the 2027 advert give no weighting or marking scheme ^{[S9][S14]} **Confirmed** . No UK private bank that I could find publishes its rubric ^[S173] **Reported** . Anyone who gives you an exact percentage is guessing. What follows is a reasoned estimate, labelled **Inferred** .

How UK employers usually mark forms like this

- **Each answer is scored against a behaviour.** The best public example is the UK Civil Service scale, which runs from 1 ("not demonstrated") to 7 ("outstanding"). The usual pass mark is 4, which means "adequate positive evidence and any negative evidence would not cause concern" ^[S173] . Other employers use a 0 to 3 scale per competency ^[S174] .
- **Markers look for three things.** Evidence of the behaviour, your own part in it ("I", not "we"), and a result you can point to ^{[S173][S175]} .
- **Screeners are wary of generic text.** In the ISE 2025 survey, 48% of employers worried that students' AI use misrepresents their skills ^[S172] . Specific, personal detail is the best defence.
- **At a small firm, a person probably reads every form.** Weatherbys hired five Associate Private Bankers in 2025 ^[S4] , so the intern cohort is likely small. That favours answers with a real voice over keyword stuffing **Inferred** .

Fig A.1 Where to spend your effort (estimate, not a published weighting)



Source: word limits and criteria from the 2027 advert (supplied verbatim). Effort split is the author's inference **Inferred**: Q2 gets the most because it maps to the job's core skill and has the largest limit. Expect each answer to be scored separately against its own criterion; a weak answer anywhere can sink the form even if the others are strong.

Mapping the advert's criteria to the three questions

"What we're looking for" (2027 advert)	Where a marker will look for it	How to show it
Due to graduate in 2027	Education section, not the essays	Gate, not scored. Make sure your dates are clear.
Curious, enthusiastic and eager to learn	Q1 mainly, Q3	Specific facts you found yourself; a question you are still asking.

Strong communication and interpersonal skills	Q2 mainly, and the writing quality of all three	Clear, short sentences. What you said, and how you listened.
Enjoy building relationships and working collaboratively	Q2, Q3	A relationship that lasted and grew, and a team you made better.
Initiative, professionalism and a strong work ethic	Q3 mainly, Q2	Something you started or took on without being asked, and sustained.
Interest in financial services, wealth management or private banking	Q1	Evidence of interest you acted on (reading, a course, a conversation, a job), not just a statement.

A likely marking grid (inferred)

Use this to self-mark your drafts. It is built from the Civil Service scale ^[S173] and the advert's criteria. It is not Weatherbys' own grid.

Score	What the answer looks like
1. Weak	Generic ("I am a people person"). Could be sent to any bank. No example, or "we" throughout. Spelling errors.
2. Adequate	A real example, but mostly description of the situation. Firm facts copied from the website homepage. Result vague.
3. Good	Clear personal actions with reasons. At least one specific Weatherbys fact. A result with some evidence. Links back to the job.
4. Stand-out	Shows <i>how</i> you think, not just what you did. A fact or link that shows research beyond the careers page (annual report, a news item, a client segment). Honest about a difficulty. The reader remembers one image from it.

THE STAND-OUT TEST, FOR ALL THREE ANSWERS

Cover the name "Weatherbys" with your thumb. If the answer still works for Coutts or Barclays, it is not finished. Then cover your own name. If the answer could have been written by any other student, it is not finished either.

A2. Question 1: "Why are you interested in a career in private banking and wealth management?" (250 words)

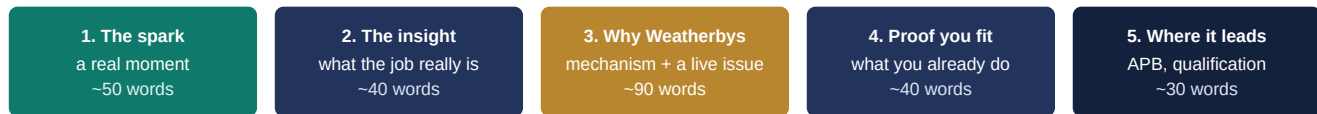
What is really being tested

- **Do you know what the job is?** Many applicants confuse private banking with investment banking or stock-picking. A private banker at Weatherbys manages a portfolio of wealthy clients (the Senior Private Banker advert says 100+) across "banking, lending and investments" ^[S24]. Most of the bank's income is interest from lending and deposits, not investment fees ^[S4].
- **Is your interest real and earned?** Have you acted on it?
- **Have you done research that a casual applicant would not?**

KEY TERM: PRIVATE BANKING VERSUS WEALTH MANAGEMENT

Private banking is personal banking for wealthy people: accounts, deposits, tailored loans and mortgages, all through one named banker. **Wealth management** is managing and planning their investments, usually for a fee based on the money managed. Weatherbys does both through one banker, with its in-house Investment & Wealth Advice (IWA) team behind them ^{[S9][S163]}. The question names both, so your answer should touch both.

The structure (about 250 words)

Fig A.2 Anatomy of a stand-out Q1 answer

Word budgets are guides. Total 250. The question asks about the career, so block 3 must stay under half the answer: it is "why this career, shown through this firm".

Stand-out moves for Q1

- 1. Start with a moment, not a statement.** Avoid "I have always been passionate about finance." Use a short scene with a person in it: a family member's mortgage, a farm's succession question, a manager at a part-time job, a client you served.
- 2. Name the mechanism you find interesting.** For example, judgement over automation. Weatherbys says lending decisions are made by "a person who understands complex HNW income structures" rather than by "automated credit scoring" ^[S17]. The CEO says: "I try and leave as much judgement and discretion with the front line as I possibly can, because that's actually what clients want" ^[S15].
- 3. Use one live issue that affects Weatherbys' clients.** The best one: since 6 April 2026, full agricultural and business property relief from inheritance tax covers only the first £2.5m per person (£5m per couple) ^[S152]. Farms, estates and family businesses are Weatherbys segments ^{[S16][S19]}. A second option: falling rates cut the bank's interest margin from 4.53% to 4.05%, which is why advice and investment income matter ^[S4].
- 4. Show that you understand the business and not only the brand.** One number is enough. Pick NPS 84 ^[S4], the "double in size" plan ^[S4], or the CEO's 10,000 to 15,000 relationship ceiling ^[S15].
- 5. End on the long term.** The APB route, a named qualification (CeMAP, IAD or PCIAM, all supported by the bank ^[S9]), and the idea of being a family's banker for decades. This fits a seven-generation family firm.

DON'T SAY THIS IN Q1

"I want to work with high-net-worth individuals" (sounds like you want proximity to money). "Fast-paced environment" (says nothing). "Prestigious" (a value judgement about the firm, not about you). Anything about trading or markets as your main motive. A list of five adjectives. Horse-racing enthusiasm you do not genuinely have: the Racing Bank is a real part of the firm and a marker who rides will spot it.

A draft frame you can build on (yellow = only you can write it)

[One concrete moment, 1-2 sentences: e.g. "When my family's farm had to refinance in 2024, the outcome turned on one banker who took the time to understand how the farm's income really worked."] It showed me that most people's financial lives do not fit a standard product, and that the most useful person in the room is the one who understands the whole picture.

That is what draws me to private banking and wealth management: the job is to know one client's lending, investments and plans well enough to make a judgement, and to keep earning their trust over years.

Weatherbys is built around that idea. One named banker covers each client's banking, lending and investments, and lending decisions are made by a person who understands complex income rather than by automated scoring. The timing interests me too. Since April 2026, inheritance tax relief on farms and family businesses has been capped at £2.5m, so many of the farming and landed families that Weatherbys serves now face new succession questions. I would like to learn how a banker helps a family through that alongside their lawyers and accountants.

[Proof, 1-2 sentences: something you already do that resembles the job, e.g. "In two years at X, I learned that customers come back to the person who remembers them."]

I also want to learn in a firm that is growing: Weatherbys plans to double in size, and its internship leads to the Associate Private Banker programme. In the long term I would like to qualify through [CeMAP / IAD] and become the banker a family keeps for decades.

About 245 words with placeholders filled. Rewrite it in your own voice: a marker who reads 100 forms will notice a template.

A3. Question 2: "Tell us about a time you built a strong relationship with someone. How did you do it?" (300 words)

What is really being tested

This is the job itself. A Weatherbys banker's career depends on whether clients trust them enough to bring the next loan, refer a friend, or stay through a bad year. The bank describes success in a banker's first year as "a strong internal network" and "a growing base of engaged clients" ^[S9]. Notice the second half of the question: **"How did you do it?"** More than half your words should go on method, not on the setting.

Choosing the right story

Strong choices	Weak choices
Someone different from you in age, background or outlook (an older customer, a client, a mentee, a colleague who was cold at first). Closest to a private banker's reality.	Your best friend, a partner or a sibling. The relationship may be real but the skill is not professional.
A relationship that started badly or had a setback you repaired, such as a complaint, a missed deadline or a disagreement.	A relationship that was easy from day one. There is nothing to show.
One where trust is visible: they came back, asked for you by name, gave you responsibility, introduced you to someone.	One where the only evidence is "we got on well".
A long period (months or years) with repeated contact.	A single event, such as a weekend group project.

Fig A.3 Q2 word budget: method is the answer

Who + why 40	The gap 30	How: three deliberate actions, each with the reason behind it 150 to 170 words	Proof 40	Lesson 25
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"The gap" is the reason the relationship was not automatic: distance, distrust, difference, a problem. Without it the story has no tension.

"Proof" is behaviour by the other person, not your feelings: they returned, referred, confided, asked for you, or stayed in touch after it ended.

"Lesson" links the method to private banking in one sentence. Do not lecture: one line is enough.

Budget is the author's guide [Inferred], built from the question wording ("How did you do it?") and standard STAR practice [S175].

Methods worth describing (pick two or three that you actually used)

- **Listening before acting:** what you asked, what you learned that others had missed.
- **Remembering and following up:** details you noted and used later. This is the core of private banking ("Banking that knows you" ^[S16]).
- **Being reliable in small things:** doing exactly what you said, by when you said.
- **Telling an uncomfortable truth well:** saying no, or giving bad news early and with an alternative. This maps to the bank's "Straightforward" and "Trusted" values ^[S4].
- **Adapting to how they communicate:** phone instead of email, in person, simpler language.
- **Connecting them to someone else who could help:** the banker's job is often to bring in the right specialist.

Frame: In [setting and dates], I [role] and was responsible for [the person: who they were, why the relationship mattered]. At first [the gap: e.g. "she had complained twice and asked not to deal with students"].

I did three things. First, I [listening action], because [why]. That showed me [what you learned that changed your approach]. Second, I [reliability action, with a specific detail: a note, a call, a deadline kept]. Third, when [a setback], I [how you handled honesty or a problem], rather than [the easier option].

[Proof: "Six months later she asked for me by name, and introduced her neighbour."]

I learned that trust is built in the small, repeated things, and that is the part of private banking I most want to learn.

Aim for 280 to 300 words. Put a number in the proof if you have one: months, visits, referrals, a result.

SENTENCE UPGRADES

Weak: "I built rapport by being friendly and approachable."

Strong: "I started writing down what he mentioned each week, his daughter's exams or his knee operation, and asked about it the next time. By the third visit he was waiting for me at the door."

Weak: "We worked well together and achieved a great result."

Strong: "When I realised I had given her the wrong date, I rang her that evening instead of emailing, explained, and offered two alternatives. She told my manager it was why she trusted us."

A4. Question 3: "What extracurricular activities, sports, societies or voluntary work are you involved in?" (250 words)

What is really being tested

- **Initiative and work ethic outside the timetable.** What did you start, lead, sustain or improve?
- **Collaboration.** How do you act in a team?
- **"Would a client enjoy an hour with this person?"** Private banking is social. The firm's own staff profiles mention "a royal archer" and a "whisky blending banker" ^[S25]. Interesting, sustained interests count **Inferred**.
- **Values fit.** The bank runs a volunteering and mentoring programme, "Creating The Future", with match-funded staff fundraising (£115k donated in 2025) and 35 mentors working with 80+ students ^[S4].

The structure: depth, breadth and a thread

Fig A.4 Q3: one in depth, one or two in brief, one thread that joins them

Main activity (~130 words)

role, how long, what you did beyond turning up, one number, what changed because of you

1-2 others (~80 words)

one line each: what, how long, one detail

The thread (~40 words)

what they show about you, and the link to the job

Prose, not a bullet list: the box rewards writing quality. Budget is the author's guide **Inferred**.

Stand-out moves for Q3

1. **Show contribution, not membership.** "Member of the finance society" scores low. "Ran the society's speaker series, booking six practitioners and raising attendance from 20 to 55" scores high.
2. **Include one activity with people outside university,** such as volunteering, coaching juniors, a part-time job or a community role. Private clients are mostly older than you and outside your world. Showing you can relate to them is valuable.
3. **Count sustained commitment.** "Every Saturday for three years" beats a list of ten one-off events.
4. **Link lightly to Weatherbys only where it is true.** For example: riding, polo, rural or farming life, mentoring (their Creating The Future programme), a charity that matches one of their 2026 partners (Alzheimer's Research UK, CALM, The Wildlife Trust BCN) ^[S4]. One genuine link is plenty. None is fine.
5. **Use the last two lines to name the pattern.** For example: "Across all three, I end up being the person others rely on to organise and follow through, and I enjoy it."

Frame: My main commitment is [activity], which I have done for [time]. As [role], I [two specific things you did beyond attending]. The result was [a number or visible change]. The hardest part was [a real difficulty], which I handled by [action].

I also [second activity, one line with one detail] and [third, one line].

What joins them is [the trait]. It is also why I am drawn to a relationship-led bank, where [link in one clause].

If you have a striking personal interest (an instrument to a high grade, a sport at county level, an unusual hobby), give it one line. It is a conversation starter at the assessment centre.

A5. Final checks before you press submit

#	Check
1	Each answer uses 90 to 100% of the limit. Being under 80% reads as low effort; going over may be cut off.
2	Write in a separate document first. Online forms (this one is on Workable) can time out. Keep a copy: the assessment centre will ask about these answers.
3	British spelling. "Weatherbys" with no apostrophe. "Associate Private Banker Programme".
4	Every firm fact in your answers is one you can explain if asked. Do not cite a number you could not defend.
5	"I" not "we" when describing actions. Past tense for the story, present tense for what you believe.
6	Read each answer aloud. Cut every sentence that sounds like a brochure.
7	Do not paste AI-written text. Use it to check and question your draft, not to write it. Markers look for this ^[S172] , and you will have to talk about these stories in person.
8	Submit a few days early (by Tuesday 20 October). Early submission costs nothing, and some employers review applications as they arrive. Whether Weatherbys does is not stated Inferred .
9	If you have a disability and want the guaranteed-interview scheme or adjustments, say so on the form. The advert says this explicitly.

PART 1

The role decoded, and the team mapped

An eight-week internship in the London Private Banking Clients team, 5 July to 26 August 2027, in person. This part takes every line of the advert, explains it, and reconstructs the team you would join.

1.1 The advert, line by line

The advert describes a programme more than a job, so the "duties" are experiences. Where I describe what a line means in practice, that is **Inferred** from the firm's careers pages and intern testimonials unless a source is given.

Advert line	What it means day to day	What it reveals about the firm
"Contribute to live projects"	A project with a deadline and an owner, often a business initiative such as research on a client segment, a process review or event support. The careers page says interns "work on a diverse range of live projects and real business challenges" ^[S9] .	With 396 staff in the Bank ^[S4] , an intern's output can actually be used. Expect a presentation at the end Inferred .
"Exposure to senior leaders"	Meetings, talks or lunches with the Head of Private Clients, team leads, possibly the CEO. The CEO says "everyone can speak to everyone, and the lines of communication are really short" ^[S15] .	A flat-in-practice firm, even though the CEO calls it "quite traditional and hierarchical" ^[S15] .
"How a relationship-led private bank operates"	Shadowing bankers in client preparation, sitting in on internal credit discussions, learning how a loan or account moves from first conversation to completion. One intern describes shadowing "investments and lending to operations, risk and compliance" ^[S9] .	The bank wants interns to see the whole chain: front office, credit, operations, compliance.
"Become part of the team"	A seat in the team, a buddy, weekly HR check-ins ^[S9] . You will be judged on how you fit in, not just your output.	A culture that hires for fit: "like-minded people giving an incredible service to like-minded clients" ^[S4] .
"Exposure across the organisation"	Time with other teams: Investment & Wealth Advice (IWA), lending and credit, client support, Racing Bank, Business Bank, perhaps operations in Wellingborough.	The front office relies on central teams. See Fig 1.3.
"Regular feedback, mentoring"	Structured check-ins, a buddy and a mentor.	Development is a stated priority; the bank supports CeMAP, IAD and PCIAM qualifications ^[S9] .
"May be considered for progression to the Associate Private Banker assessment process"	A good internship does not guarantee an APB place, but it opens the assessment. A current private banker, Darcy, says: "After an Internship at the Bank, I came to Weatherbys straight from university, on the Associate Private Banker programme" ^[S9] .	The internship is a hiring funnel. Treat all eight weeks as an assessment.

1.2 A realistic day in the seat

SOURCE UNCERTAIN

No Weatherbys intern timetable is public. This day is built from the careers page, the intern testimonial and how private banks generally work ^{[S9][S164]}. Treat it as a plausible illustration **Inferred**.

Fig 1.1 An illustrative intern day, London office [Inferred]

08:30 Read the news: rates, markets, tax stories that touch clients	09:00 Team meeting: pipeline, client events, who needs help this week	10:00 Shadow a banker: prepare a client meeting pack, take notes	12:30 Lunch with buddy or a talk from a senior leader	14:00 Live project: research, data, draft slides for a team lead	16:00 Session with IWA, credit or compliance	17:30 Write up notes, plan tomorrow, occasional client event evening
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Inputs: intern testimonial on shadowing "investments and lending to operations, risk and compliance" and the bank's client events (Royal Ascot, Cheltenham, polo) ^{[S9][S33]}. Times are illustrative.

1.3 The private banker's job, which is what you are being assessed for

- **Portfolio.** A banker covers "a portfolio of 100+ private banking clients" ^[S24] **Reported**, as their "trusted point of contact across banking, lending and investments".
- **Support.** Each client gets a "named private banker and assistant from day one" ^[S16]. Investment advice comes from the in-house IWA team; tax questions can go to a Senior Tax Adviser ^{[S9][S13]}.
- **Lending.** Residential mortgages, bridging loans, secured loans and Lombard loans (borrowing against an investment portfolio, up to 50% loan-to-value) ^{[S17][S18]}. Underwriting is "flexible" rather than "fixed criteria and automated credit scoring" ^[S17].
- **Winning clients.** Business development is "very" important "but in a relationship-led way" ^[S9]. Referrals come from existing clients and professional introducers such as lawyers and accountants ^[S164].
- **What success looks like in year one:** "a strong internal network, a growing base of engaged clients, sound judgement, confidence in lending and investment conversations, contribution to team culture" ^[S9].

KEY TERMS

Loan-to-value (LTV): loan size divided by the value of the security. A £340k loan on a £1m house is 34% LTV. Lower means safer for the bank.

Lombard loan: a loan secured on an investment portfolio rather than property.

Bridging loan: a short loan to cover a gap, for example buying a new house before the old one sells.

KYC / AML: Know Your Customer and Anti-Money Laundering. The checks a bank must do on who a client is and where their money comes from.

1.4 Controls and compliance: what an intern must know unprompted

Bright line	Why it exists	What to say if asked
Client confidentiality	Wealthy clients' affairs are private; banks owe a duty of confidentiality, and UK GDPR covers personal data.	"I would not discuss a client outside the people who need to know, including friends and family."
KYC / AML and source of wealth	Money-laundering rules. Wealthy clients with complex income are higher-risk by nature.	"If something didn't add up, I'd raise it with the banker or compliance, not investigate it myself or tip off the client."

Consumer Duty	FCA rule since 31 July 2023: firms must "deliver good outcomes for retail customers", including wealthy individuals ^[S140] .	"Good outcomes, fair value, clear communication, extra care for vulnerable clients."
Vulnerable clients	Older clients may have health or capacity issues. Weatherbys has hired dementia specialists ^[S150] Reported .	"I'd notice and flag, not decide."
Advice is regulated	Only qualified, authorised people give investment or mortgage advice.	"As an intern I wouldn't give advice; I'd make sure the client reached the right person."
Gifts and hospitality	Conflicts of interest.	"I'd declare anything offered and follow the policy."

1.5 Career path from this seat

Fig 1.2 The ladder, from titles on the firm's own team page

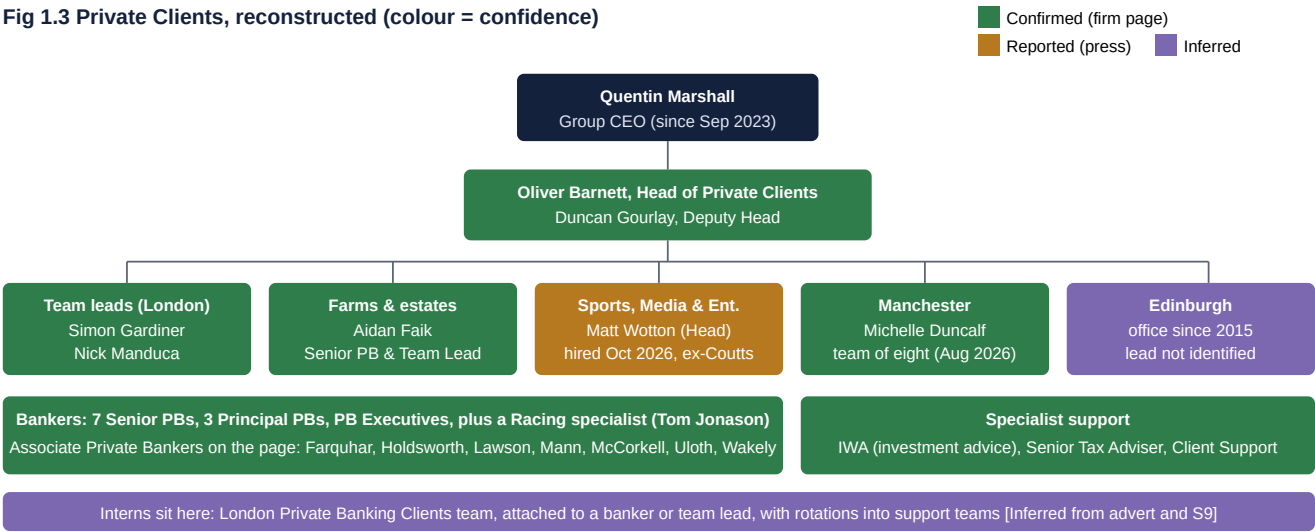


Source: titles on the "Our team" page [S13]; APB is "a fast-track route into qualifying as a Private Banker in two years" [S9]. Order of the middle titles is inferred from seniority words [Inferred]. Five APBs and seven Private Bankers joined in 2025 [S4]. Qualifications the bank supports: CeMAP (mortgages), IAD (investment advice), PCIAM (wealth management) [S9].

1.6 The team, reconstructed

Method. Weatherbys publishes no org chart. I rebuilt one from the names and titles on its "Our team" page ^[S13], press releases about recent hires ^{[S20][S31]} and the annual report ^[S4]. Job adverts on Workable could not be read for this pack, because the site blocked automated access, so the structure below relies on the firm's own pages.

Fig 1.3 Private Clients, reconstructed (colour = confidence)



Sources: [S13] team page (accessed 7 Oct 2026); [S20] Duncalf hire (Jul 2025); [S19b] Manchester move (Aug 2026); [S31] Wotton hire (6 Oct 2026). Reporting lines between boxes are inferred.

Headcount estimate

Front-line private banking: roughly 50 to 90 people **Inferred**. Method: the team page lists about 30 senior bankers and specialists, plus 7 APBs ^[S13]. The bank pairs every banker with an assistant ^[S16], which roughly doubles the front-line count. Some people, including recent hires, are not on the page ^[S31]. The Bank as a whole

has 396 staff and the Group 483 ^[S4] **Confirmed** . Most of the rest work in operations, technology, risk and finance at the Wellingborough head office **Inferred** .

How the work splits: by geography (London, Manchester, Edinburgh), by client segment (farms and estates, racing, sport and entertainment, law firm partners, entrepreneurs, non-residents and US citizens) and by seniority ^{[S13][S16]} .

PART 2

The firm as a business, from the inside

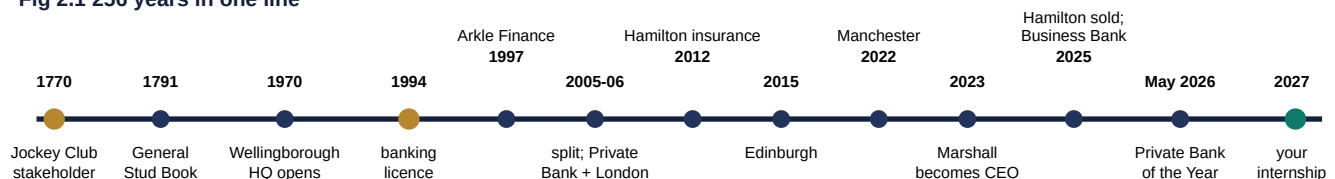
Where it came from, how the money moves, what each party gives and gets, how risk is controlled, and what has changed in the last two years.

2.1 The founding insight: a business built on being trusted with other people's money

In 1770 the Jockey Club appointed James Weatherby, a Northumbrian solicitor, as its Secretary, "Keeper of the Matchbook and Stakeholder" ^[S5] **Confirmed**. A stakeholder literally held the stakes, the money riding on a race, until the result was known. The family then kept racing's records: the first Racing Calendar in 1773 and the General Stud Book in 1791 ^[S5]. So the business began as the neutral, trusted keeper of money and records for a close community. That is still the pitch of a private bank 256 years later.

The bank came much later. Weatherbys got its banking licence from the Bank of England in 1994. Sir Johnny Weatherby was "instrumental in obtaining our banking licence" ^[S4]. In 2005 the business split into Weatherbys Ltd (racing services) and Weatherbys Banking Group. In 2006 it formed the Private Bank and the Racing Bank and opened in central London ^[S5].

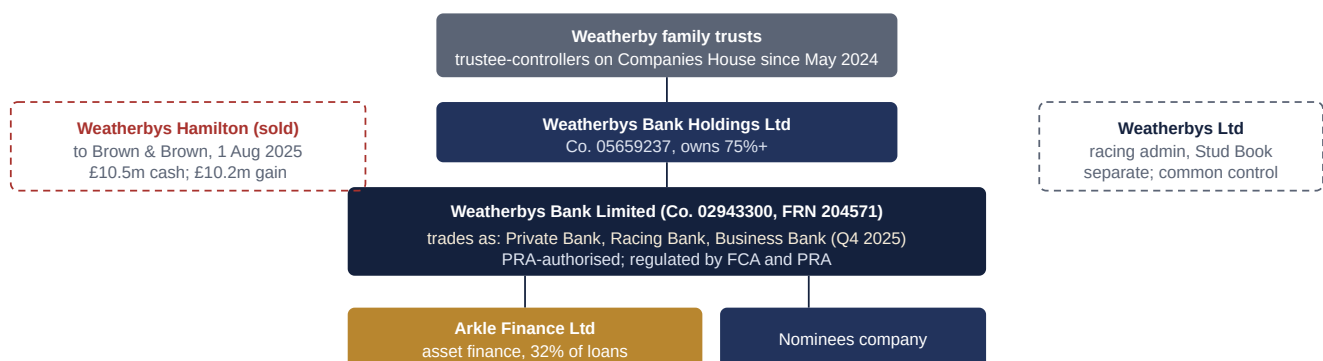
Fig 2.1 256 years in one line



Sources: history page ^[S5]; annual report 2025 ^[S4]; Citywealth ^[S26]. Spacing is not to scale.

2.2 Who owns it and how the group fits together

Fig 2.2 Group structure (as of October 2026)



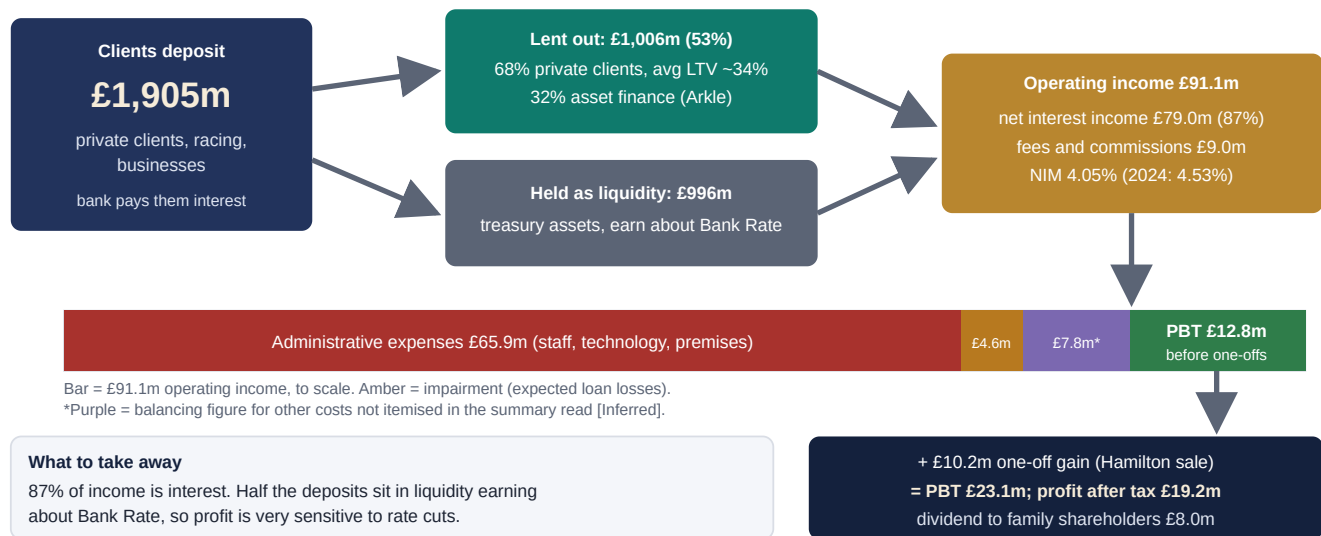
Sources: Companies House ^{[S2][S6][S7]}; annual report 2025 ^[S4]. Family ownership via trusts is inferred from PSC filings and the firm's description of itself as "family-owned" ^[Confirmed for "family-owned", Inferred for trust detail].

- **Private and family-owned.** The bank calls itself "a seventh generation, family-owned bank" ^[S4]. Max Weatherby joined in early 2026 as "the first member of the eighth generation" ^[S4]. Roger and Johnny Weatherby stopped being registered controllers of the holding company in May 2024, when trustee-controllers were registered ^[S7].

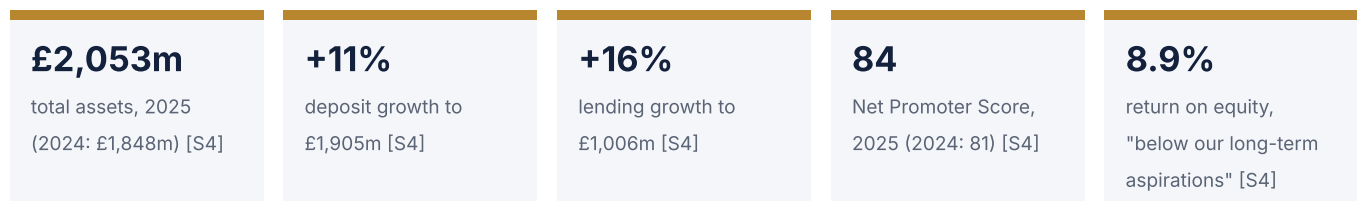
- **Why private ownership matters for your research.** There are no analyst reports, share price or earnings calls. The best sources are the annual report, Companies House, Pillar 3 disclosures and trade press. Quoting the annual report shows effort most applicants will not make.
- **Leadership.** Chairman Roger Weatherby (CEO 2000 to 2023, chairman since March 2024). CEO Quentin Marshall (since September 2023, ex-Coutts and UBS). Non-executive directors include Rory Tapner (CEO of Coutts 2010 to 2015, joined October 2025) and Aileen Wallace (fintech, January 2026) ^{[S4][S15]} **Confirmed**.

2.3 How the money moves

Fig 2.3 The money machine, FY2025 (year to 31 Dec 2025)

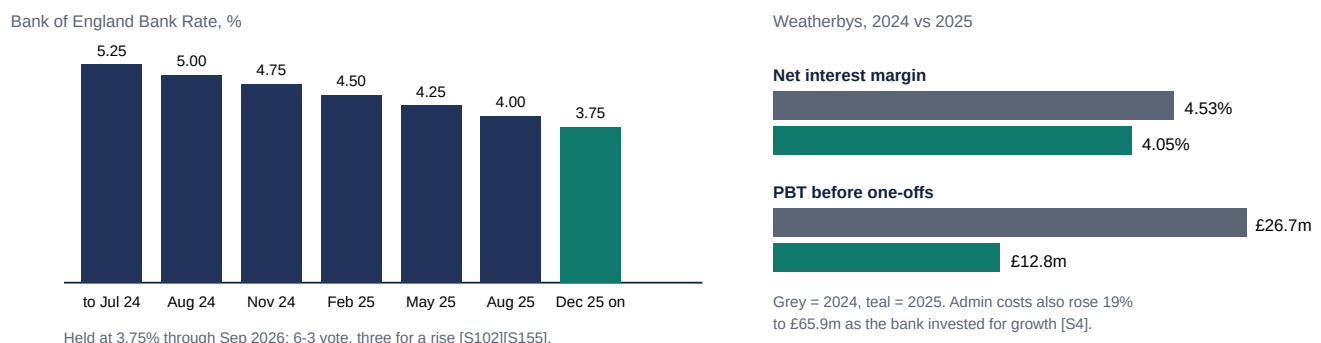


Source: Weatherbys Banking Group Annual Report and Financial Accounts 2025, signed 21 Apr 2026 [S4]. All figures Group, FY2025.
[Confirmed] NIM = net interest margin, the interest earned minus interest paid, as a share of interest-earning assets.



2.4 Why profit halved, and why that is a good thing to understand

Fig 2.4 Bank Rate fell, so the margin and underlying profit fell



Sources: Bank Rate path [S155] (snippet, consistent with [S105][S110]); Weatherbys figures [S4]. Bars to scale within each panel.

Two things happened at once. Rates fell, which squeezed the margin on the bank's large pool of deposits. At the same time, the bank chose to spend more: costs rose 19%, including over £8m on technology, new bankers, a Business Bank and a new London office ^[S4]. The CEO frames this as investment for the plan to "double in size over the next five years" ^[S4].

YOUR OPINION GOES HERE

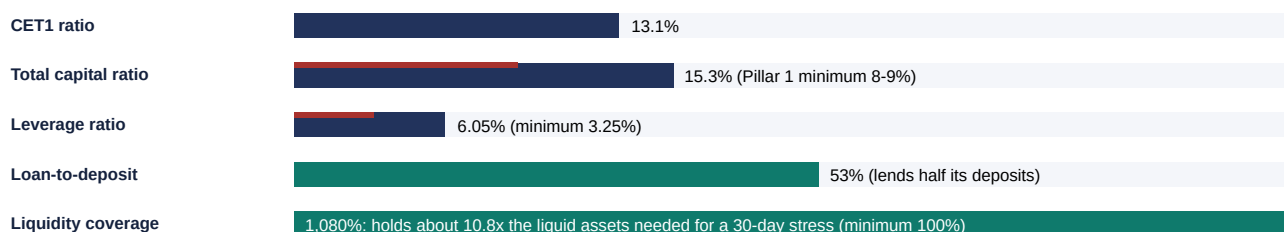
Is it right to invest heavily while margins are falling? **For:** independents win share when big banks raise minimums and standardise service (Part 8); the balance sheet is very strong (Section 2.6). **Against:** ROE of 8.9% is below the bank's own aspiration, and if rates fall further the margin squeeze continues. A balanced line: *"It's a bet that service and new segments grow fee and lending income faster than rates erode the deposit margin. The 30% growth in investment assets under advice suggests it is starting to work."* ^[S4]

2.5 The "contracts" the business is made of

Party	What they give	What they get
Private client	Deposits (often large), borrowing, investment assets, fees, loyalty and referrals.	A named banker and assistant, human lending decisions, quick answers, events, and an institution that has lasted 256 years ^{[S16][S17]} .
Private banker	Judgement, time, a growing client book, compliance with credit and conduct rules.	Discretion: "I try and leave as much judgement and discretion with the front line as I possibly can" ^[S15] . Specialist support from IWA, tax and credit.
Family shareholders	Patient capital. No pressure for quarterly results.	Dividends (£8.0m in 2025) and a long-term family asset ^[S4] .
Regulators (PRA, FCA)	Permission to take deposits and lend.	Capital above requirements, liquidity, fair treatment of customers. The PRA sets the bank's Total Capital Requirement (£60.5m against £105.5m held in 2025) ^[S4] .
Racing community	Accounts and payments from owners, trainers and syndicates.	Specialist products such as the Racehorse VAT Return Service and syndicate accounts that "a High Street bank" would refuse ^{[S15][S21]} .

2.6 The risk architecture: why the balance sheet is so conservative

Fig 2.5 Five numbers that say "safe", FY2025 vs regulatory floor



Source: ^[S4] FY2025; leverage minimum per ^[S4]; Pillar 1 note from 2024 Pillar 3 ^[S22]. Capital and leverage bars on a 0-40% scale (red tick = minimum); loan-to-deposit on a 0-100% scale; the LCR is too large for either and is shown as a full bar.

- **Private client loans are low-risk.** They are "secured principally on residential properties at an average loan to value ratio of approximately 34%" ^[S4]. House prices would have to fall about two-thirds before the average loan lost money ^{Inferred}.
- **Liquidity is huge.** A liquidity coverage ratio (LCR) of 1,080% means the bank holds about ten times the cash-like assets needed to survive a 30-day run. That matters to clients with deposits well above the £120,000

compensation limit ^[S145].

- **The CEO's words:** "Managing risk is fundamental to any Bank. For us, it is second nature. We understand our top priority is keeping our clients' money safe" ^[S4].

KEY TERMS

CET1 ratio: the bank's highest-quality capital (mainly shareholders' equity) as a share of risk-weighted assets. It is the main cushion against losses.

Liquidity coverage ratio (LCR): liquid assets divided by the cash the bank could lose in a 30-day stress. It must be at least 100%.

Impairment: money set aside for loans that may not be repaid. Weatherbys' charge was £4.6m in both 2024 and 2025.

2.7 What has changed in the last 24 months

Date	Event	Why it matters to you
Jan 2025	Five-year renewal of the Weatherbys Super Sprint at Newbury, sponsored since 1993 ^[S23] (Weatherbys brand, not specifically the Bank)	Racing roots are being kept, not dropped.
Jul 2025	Michelle Duncalf hired from Coutts to lead Manchester. Rory Tapner (ex-Coutts CEO) to the board ^[S20]	A pattern: senior Coutts people choosing Weatherbys.
1 Aug 2025	Weatherbys Hamilton insurance stake sold to Brown & Brown for £10.5m ^{[S4][S11]}	Focus: "simplifying its operating model and concentrating on its core strengths" ^[S4] .
2025	Charge Card, USD and EUR debit cards, execution-only investing via Saxo, London staff move to Shaftesbury Avenue ^[S4]	Product build-out behind "100 per cent human, 100 per cent digital" ^[S15] .
Q4 2025	Weatherbys Business Bank launched ^[S4]	New segment: owner-managed and specialist businesses.
Dec 2025	Death of Sir Johnny Weatherby, bank chairman 1994 to 2017 ^[S4]	Handle with care if it comes up.
Jan 2026	Aileen Wallace (fintech) joins the board. CEO strategy interview ^[S15]	Digital bank and new client interface due in 2026 ^[S4] .
20 May 2026	Citywealth Magic Circle Awards: "Private Bank of the Year", "recognised for rapid growth and successful diversification beyond its traditional roots" ^[S26]	A fresh, external fact to cite.
Aug 2026	Manchester team (eight people) moves to Sunlight House, Spinningfields ^[S19b]	Regional growth outside London.
25 Aug 2026	Lombard lending extended to portfolios managed elsewhere ^[S27]	Clients can borrow without moving their investments. Good for winning new clients.
15 Sep 2026	Racing Bank funds maths and English tutors for British Racing School apprentices ^[S30]	Community and racing link.
6 Oct 2026	Matt Wotton (12+ years Coutts) hired as Head of Sports, Media & Entertainment; Luke Page as Principal Private Banker; "nearly a dozen new bankers" in 18 months ^[S31]	The newest fact. One day old as of this pack.

2.8 Things that should not surprise you

- **No regulatory fines or enforcement found** in searches of public sources **Reported**. One Financial Ombudsman decision appeared in search results but was not read ^[S32].
- **Profit before one-offs halved in 2025** (Section 2.4). Know the reason; do not be thrown if asked.
- **Gender pay gap**: median 31.4%, mean 36.2% (2025 report). HR Director Tom O'Reilly writes that the bank "must do more" ^[S34]. If diversity comes up, acknowledge it calmly; it is common in private banking because senior banker roles are male-dominated.
- **Self-description as "traditional and hierarchical"**. The CEO's own words ^[S15]. Do not call the firm "stuffy", but do not pretend it is a start-up.

PART 3

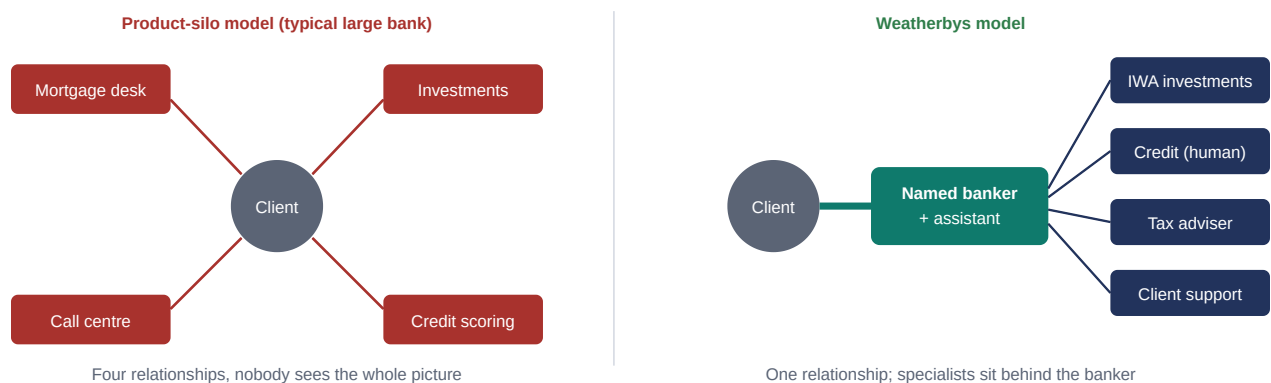
Why the firm is built this way

Four questions: why the structure, how the teams work together, what clients are really buying, and what the rest of the group does. This is the material that makes "why Weatherbys" more than adjectives.

3.1 One banker, the whole client: why that design?

Most large banks split a wealthy client across specialists: a mortgage team, an investment manager, a call centre for daily banking. Weatherbys gives one banker the whole relationship, with specialists behind them rather than in front of the client ^{[S9][S16]}.

Fig 3.1 Two ways to serve a wealthy family



Sources: "Named private banker and assistant from day one" ^[S16]; holistic across lending, IWA investment and daily banking ^[S9]; human credit decisions ^[S17]. The left panel is a stylised alternative, not a description of any named bank ^[Inferred].

The theory behind it

- Wealthy clients' affairs are complex, and the complexity lives between products.** A farm owner's mortgage, inheritance plan and business account all interact. Only someone who sees all three can spot the problem or opportunity ^[Inferred].
- Human credit decisions win the clients that computers reject.** The CEO's example is racing syndicates: "You can try and open an account for it with a High Street bank, but it would be close to impossible. The computer says: 'No!'" ^[S15]. Lending is "flexible underwriting rather than fixed criteria" with no upper age limit, and land and investment portfolios are accepted as security ^[S17].
- The relationship is the product.** Board member Rory Tapner: "Pushing products won't work for the type of clients Weatherbys seeks to attract" ^[S4]. The careers page: "exceptional service, trust and holistic advice rather than product pushing" ^[S9].
- Low risk follows from knowing the client.** The bank says it is conservative because it knows its borrowers, and its loans average about 34% loan-to-value ^[S4] ^[Inferred link].

What the design costs

- It does not scale infinitely.** The CEO says "the upper limit for being able to be so flexible is 10,000 to 15,000 private banking relationships" ^[S15]. Growth means hiring bankers, which is expensive. That is one reason costs rose 19% in 2025 ^[S4].
- Key-person risk.** If a banker leaves, clients may follow. That is why the bank invests in culture and in growing its own bankers through the APB programme ^[Inferred].
- Judgement must be controlled.** Discretion at the front line needs strong credit oversight, and the bank has a board Risk Committee chaired by Jane Millar ^[S4].

3.2 How the teams work together

Fig 3.2 The operating model in three layers



Sources: [S4] for spend, funds and deposits; locations [S3][S13]. Allocation of central functions to Wellingborough is inferred from the registered office and the third-party risk role advertised there [S35] [Inferred].

The firm's words for its culture are "collaborative, high-trust and client-obsessed" [S9]. In practice collaboration lives in four places:

- **Banker and IWA:** the investment team works behind the banker. Investment assets under advice grew 30% in 2025, 74% of it from new money [S4].
- **Banker and credit:** every loan is a conversation between the banker, who knows the client, and the credit team, who protect the balance sheet.
- **Across segments:** a racing owner may also be a farm owner and an entrepreneur. Segment teams are labels for expertise, not walls [Inferred].
- **Across the group:** referrals between the Private Bank, Racing Bank, Business Bank and Arkle [Inferred].

3.3 What clients are actually buying

Fig 3.3 The client segments, all served through one named banker



Source: segment list on the firm's Private Bank and specialist-banking pages [S13][S16], accessed 7 Oct 2026. Circle size carries no meaning (client numbers by segment are not published).

What they buy	Evidence
Access to a decision-maker	"Every decision is made by a person who understands complex HNW income structures" [S17].

Service quality	NPS 84 in 2025 ^[S4] , against 74 at Hoare's (FY2025) and 75 at Hampden (H1 2026) ^{[S105][S128]} . The CEO: "I suspect no other bank in the UK will have a higher degree of support from their clients" ^[S4] . These are self-reported scores on possibly different methods.
Safety for big balances	LCR 1,080%, total capital 15.3% ^[S4] . Deposits above the FSCS limit of £120,000 depend on the bank's own strength ^[S145] .
Specialist understanding	Teams for farms and estates, racing, sport and entertainment ^{[S13][S31]} . Racing-specific products ^[S21] .
Continuity	A family firm since 1770, with an eighth generation now joining ^[S4] .

THE COUNTER-CASE, WITH NUMBERS

Clients also accept trade-offs. Weatherbys is small: £1.9bn of deposits against £6.4bn at Hoare's and £41.4bn in NatWest's wealth division, which includes Coutts ^{[S4][S105][S103]}. It has fewer branches, less in-house investment scale and a narrower digital offer than the large banks (the new digital bank was only due in 2026 ^[S4]). Minimum criteria are not published, so it is unclear how selective it is ^[S16].

3.4 The rest of the group: Racing Bank, Business Bank and Arkle

- **Racing Bank:** the original community. It offers racing accounts, a Racehorse VAT Return Service, a Racing Payment Service and syndicate accounts ^[S21]. In 2025 it changed onboarding for multi-owner syndicates after industry feedback ^[S4].
- **Arkle Finance:** asset finance (loans to buy equipment and vehicles), 32% of the group's loan book. 2025 profit before tax was £5.6m, up from £3.5m. The aim is to double to "£600 million of lending by 2030" ^[S4].
- **Business Bank:** launched in Q4 2025 for owner-managed businesses and "specialist or complex sectors" such as charities and high-growth companies ^[S4].
- **Central functions:** the Bank has 396 staff, most of them outside the front line ^[S4] **Inferred**. A Third Party Risk Management Specialist role in Wellingborough was live on 7 October 2026 ^[S35].

PART 4

How Weatherbys stands out

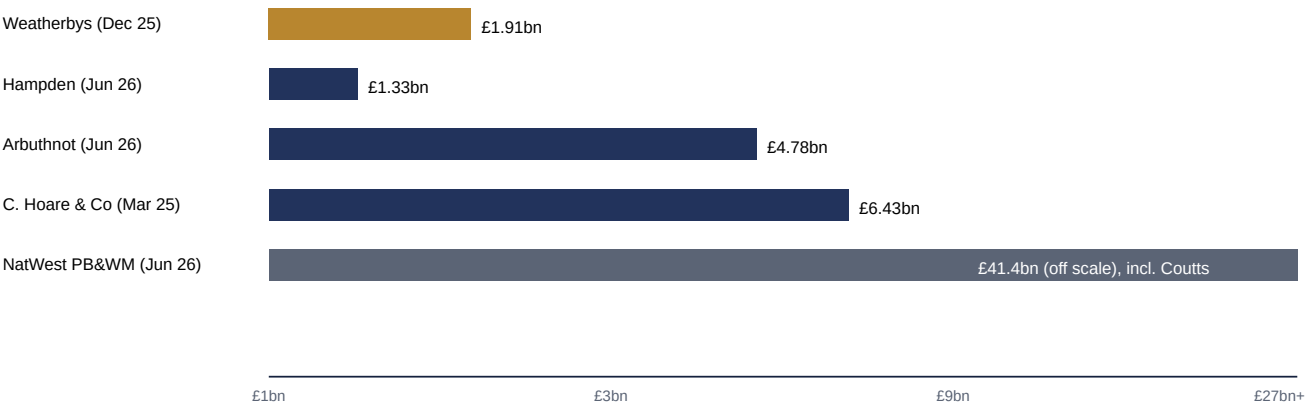
The peer set, the design choices, and the claims only Weatherbys can make. Plus where it does not lead, so you never overclaim.

4.1 The peer set

Firm	Founded	Ownership	Size (dated)	Positioning
Weatherbys	1770 (bank licence 1994)	Family, via trusts	Deposits £1,905m; loans £1,006m; PBT £12.8m pre one-offs (FY2025) ^[S4]	Relationship bank with specialist segments; racing roots
C. Hoare & Co	1672	Family (12th generation)	Deposits £6,427m; lending £2,352m; PBT £63.7m (FY to Mar 2025) ^[S105]	"Pure banking"; no in-house investment management
Coutts (NatWest)	1692	NatWest Group	NatWest wealth division deposits £41.4bn; about £131bn client assets after Evelyn (Jun 2026) ^[S103]	Best-known UK private bank; typical entry £1m+ ^[S120]
Arbuthnot Latham	1833	AIM-listed group	Deposits £4.78bn; loans £2.45bn; H1 PBT £11.0m (Jun 2026) ^{[S109][S110]}	Private, commercial, wealth and specialist lending
Hampden Bank	2015 launch	Independent investors	Deposits £1.327bn; loans £661m; H1 PBT £4.7m (Jun 2026) ^[S128]	Closest independent peer by size; Edinburgh HQ
Investec UK private banking	n/v	Listed group	8,200 UK private clients, targeting +5,000 (May 2026) ^[S113]	"High-income, time-poor" professionals
Barclays Private Bank	n/v	Barclays plc	AUM £55.8bn; H1 attributable profit £148m (Jun 2026) ^[S115]	Global bank, UHNW and HNW
UBP (UK), ex-Kleinwort Hambros	n/v	Swiss UBP since Apr 2025	Added over £21.9bn AUM to UBP ^[S125]	Now part of a Swiss private bank

n/v = not verified in this research. Figures use different reporting dates and definitions, so they show scale rather than a precise ranking.

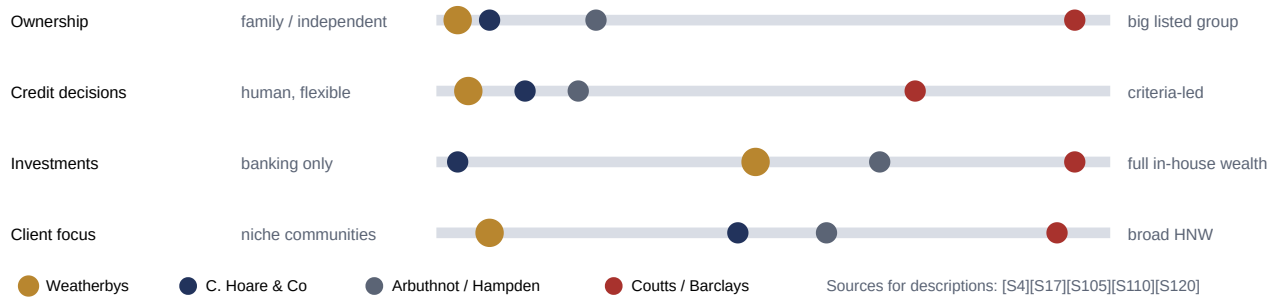
Fig 4.1 Deposits of UK private-bank peers (log scale, £bn)



Sources: [S4][S128][S110][S105][S103]. Log scale: each gridline step is a tripling. Different year-ends; comparison is approximate. NatWest bar truncated.

4.2 Design choices: where Weatherbys sits

Fig 4.2 Four design axes (author's placement from public descriptions) [Inferred]



4.3 What only Weatherbys can claim

Claim	Evidence	Why it matters
1. Born as racing's trusted stakeholder (1770), and still racing's bank	History page ^[S5] ; Racing Bank products ^[S21] ; British Racing School tutoring partnership ^[S30]	A community that a high street bank "would" reject is served as a specialism ^[S15] .
2. Highest published NPS among the peers checked: 84	[S4] vs 74 at Hoare's ^[S105] , 75 at Hampden ^[S128]	Service is measured, not just claimed. Self-reported scores, so say "published".
3. Seven generations of one family, eighth now joining	[S4]	Long-term decisions; family clients relate to a family firm. Hoare's is the other family peer, so pair this with claim 1.
4. A deliberate size ceiling for flexibility	"10,000 to 15,000 private banking relationships" ^[S15]	Growth is bounded by service quality, an unusual thing for a CEO to say.
5. Coutts talent moving to Weatherbys	Marshall (2015), Duncalf (2025), Tapner (board, 2025), Wotton (Oct 2026) ^{[S4][S20][S31]}	Experienced bankers choose it for "a more entrepreneurial environment" (Duncalf) ^[S20] .
6. Very conservative balance sheet while growing	LDR 53%, LCR 1,080%, average private LTV ~34% ^[S4]	Room to lend more as it grows; safety for large depositors.
7. Private Bank of the Year 2026 for "diversification beyond its traditional roots"	Citywealth, 20 May 2026 ^[S26]	External validation of the strategy.

DON'T OVERCLAIM

Weatherbys is **not** the oldest UK bank: Hoare's (1672) and Coutts (1692) are older, and Weatherbys' banking licence dates from 1994 ^{[S5][S121][S120]}. It is **not** the biggest or the most profitable. Its 2025 return on equity of 8.9% is "below our long-term aspirations" ^[S4]. Its digital offer is still being built ^[S4]. Say "one of the UK's few remaining family-owned private banks", not "the oldest" or "the leading".

PART 5

The industry from zero

What private banking is, how it differs from its neighbours, who the players are, and the forces reshaping it.

5.1 Four kinds of banking, side by side

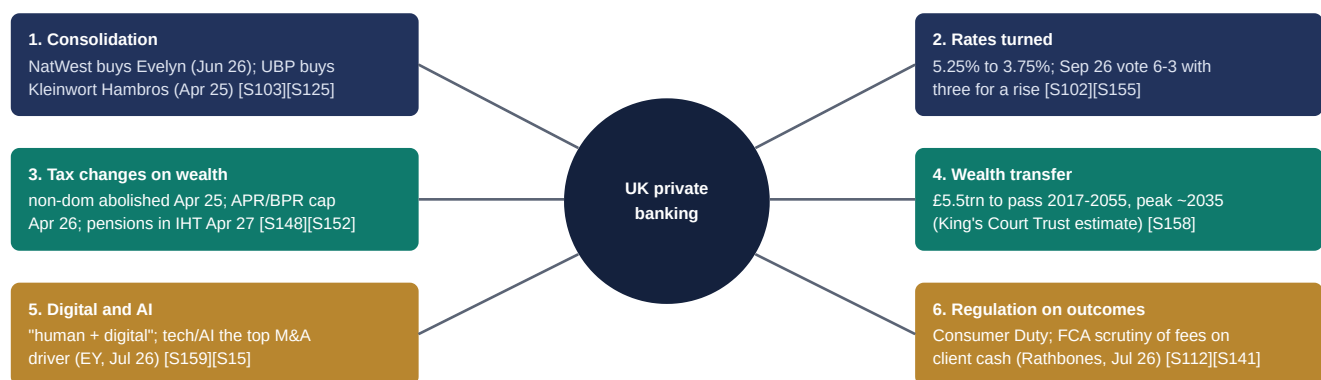
Type	Who it serves	What it does	How it makes money
Retail banking	Everyone	Standard accounts, mortgages, cards, digital payments; "standardized products, automated processes" ^[S163]	Interest margin at volume, plus fees
Private banking	Wealthy individuals, families, their businesses	Accounts, deposits, bespoke lending, FX, payments through a named relationship manager ^[S163]	Mainly net interest income; some fees
Wealth management	Affluent and wealthy clients	Investment management, financial and estate planning ^[S163]	Fees, usually a percentage of assets managed
Investment banking	Companies, governments, institutions	Mergers advice, raising capital, trading	Advisory and underwriting fees, trading

SAY THIS IN THE INTERVIEW

"A private bank like Weatherbys is mostly a lending and deposit business wrapped in a relationship. About 87% of its income is net interest. Investment advice is growing, and that matters because it is less sensitive to Bank Rate." ^[S4]

5.2 The structural forces reshaping UK private banking

Fig 5.1 The industry shift map, 2024 to 2030



Sources as tagged in each box. Wealth-transfer figure is a firm's estimate, from a search snippet [Reported].

- **Consolidation.** In H1 2026, UK financial services deal value rose from £4.2bn to £33.7bn, and wealth and asset management deals from £200m to £22.7bn (EY data) ^[S159]. Legacy names have gone: Child & Co's last branch closed in June 2022, and Adam & Co's banking moved into Coutts in 2022 ^{[S123][S120]}.
- **Deposit competition.** Hoare's grew deposits 5% "despite the headwind of quantitative tightening and competition from tax-advantaged gilts" ^[S105]. Hampden grew deposits 36% in a year ^[S128].
- **Wealth leaving the UK.** HMRC data shows non-dom taxpayers fell from 83,100 to 81,900 in the last year of the old regime ^[S149]. Henley projected a net loss of 16,500 millionaires in 2025, but its projections are disputed

[S161]

5.3 Three competing views of the next three to five years

View A: scale wins

Bank-owned groups combine banking, investment and advice. They spread technology and regulatory costs across more clients and squeeze smaller independents.

Evidence: NatWest plus Evelyn at about £131bn of client assets; the M&A surge [S103][S159]

View B: boutiques win

When big brands raise minimums and standardise, clients who want a named banker and flexible lending move to independents.

Evidence: Weatherbys NPS 84, Hampden +36% deposits, Investec adding 5,000 UK clients; the lighter SDDT capital regime from 2027 [S4][S128][S113][S143]

View C: tax and policy decide

Tax changes shift value from holding deposits to advice, succession and lending around tax events. Rates stay volatile.

Evidence: APR/BPR cap, pensions in IHT, and the September hike votes [S152][S154][S102]

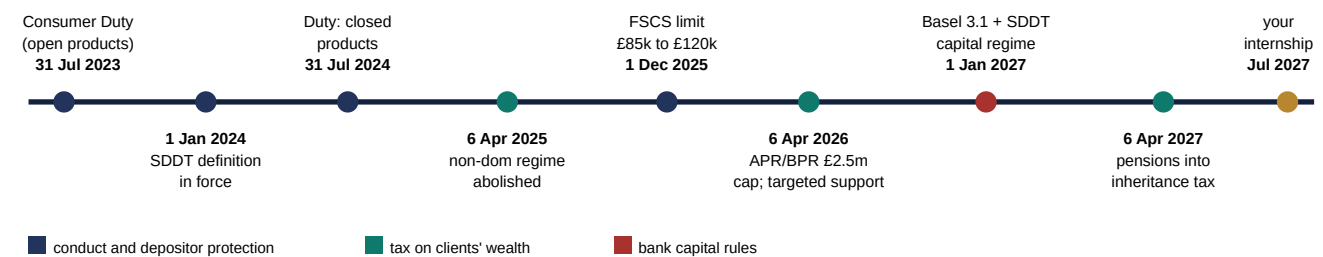
The three views are the research team's synthesis from the sources tagged, not one publication's forecast **Inferred**.

PART 6

Regulation and tax that shape private banking now

Get these dates exactly right. Most applicants will be vague, and a precise date is an easy way to sound credible.

Fig 6.1 Regulation and tax timeline, 2023 to 2027



Sources: [S140][S142][S143][S145][S146][S148][S152][S154][S156]. Spacing not to scale.

Rule	What it is, in plain English	Why Weatherbys cares
Consumer Duty 31 Jul 2023 / 31 Jul 2024	FCA Principle 12: firms must "act to deliver good outcomes for retail customers". It covers products, price and value, understanding and support [S140]. An FCA review in July 2026 found firms "describing processes" without showing that products had actually been adapted [S141].	Wealthy individuals are still retail customers. Covers fair value of fees and interest, and care for vulnerable clients.
FSCS deposit limit 1 Dec 2025	If a UK bank fails, the Financial Services Compensation Scheme repays depositors up to £120,000 (was £85,000). Temporary high balances, such as house-sale money, are covered up to £1.4m for six months [S145].	Private clients often hold far more, so the bank's own strength is part of the product.
APR / BPR cap 6 Apr 2026	Agricultural and Business Property Relief: farms and family businesses used to pass on free of inheritance tax. Now 100% relief applies only to the first £2.5m per person. Above that, the effective rate is 20%. Couples can pass on up to £5m [S152]. The cap was raised from a proposed £1m on 23 December 2025.	The most important one for you. Farms and estates are a core Weatherbys segment. Families need succession planning, lifetime gifting, and liquidity to pay tax without selling land.
Pensions in IHT 6 Apr 2027	Unused pension pots will count towards the estate for inheritance tax [S154].	More estates pay inheritance tax, so demand for planning rises.
Non-dom abolition 6 Apr 2025	The old "remittance basis" for UK residents domiciled abroad was replaced by a four-year residence-based regime [S148].	Affects internationally mobile clients. Weatherbys has a non-resident segment, but most of its clients are UK-rooted Inferred .
Strong and Simple (SDDT) capital regime 1 Jan 2027	Simpler prudential rules from the PRA for small domestic deposit-takers with up to £20bn of assets [S143][S144].	Could cut the regulatory cost burden for a bank of Weatherbys' size. Whether it has opted in is not verified, so ask rather than assert.
Basel 3.1 1 Jan 2027	The final set of international capital rules, phased in fully by 2030 [S146].	Changes how much capital a bank holds against mortgages and loans.

Bank Rate 3.75%	Held on 17 September 2026 by 6 votes to 3, with three members wanting 4%. CPI inflation was 3.1% in August. Next decision 5 November 2026 ^[S102] .	Directly drives Weatherbys' interest margin (Fig 2.4).
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THE SINGLE HIGHEST-VALUE TECHNICAL POINT

"Since 6 April 2026, farms and family businesses only get full inheritance tax relief on the first £2.5 million per person, with about 20% tax above that. For Weatherbys' farming and landed clients, that turns succession from a lawyer's question into a banking question too: how to fund a tax bill without selling land. The banker's job is to coordinate with the family's lawyer and accountant, not to give the tax advice."
^{[S152][S19]}

PART 7

What is happening right now

Ten stories from April to October 2026. For each: what happened, why it matters to Weatherbys, and something you could say or ask.

Story (outlet, date)	Plain-English explanation	Your angle
Weatherbys hires ex-Coutts head for Sports, Media & Entertainment (WealthBriefing, 6 Oct 2026) [S31]	Matt Wotton, 12+ years at Coutts, joins to lead a new specialist team. Nearly a dozen bankers hired in 18 months.	"What does a sports or entertainment client need that a farming client doesn't?" Irregular income, short careers, image rights.
Bank Rate held at 3.75%, vote 6-3 (Bank of England, 17 Sep 2026) [S102]	Three of nine members wanted a rise to 4%. Inflation 3.1%.	A rate rise would help Weatherbys' deposit margin but make borrowing dearer for clients. Both sides.
Racing Bank funds tutors for British Racing School apprentices (TDN, 15 Sep 2026) [S30]	The bank pays for roving maths and English tutors for young people entering racing.	Community roots; links to the bank's Creating The Future programme [S4].
Weatherbys extends Lombard lending to externally managed portfolios (TheWealthNet, 25 Aug 2026) [S27]	Clients can now borrow against investments held at another firm.	A way to win a client's banking without asking them to move their investments first.
Hampden Bank profit up 91% (Scottish Financial News, 10 Aug 2026) [S129]	The closest independent peer: H1 profit £4.7m, deposits +36%.	Evidence for "View B": relationship banks are growing.
NatWest completes Evelyn Partners deal (NatWest results, 31 Jul 2026) [S103]	Coutts' parent buys a large wealth manager for £2.7bn.	The biggest competitor got bigger. Where does that leave a boutique?
Rathbones cuts margin outlook during FCA review (AJ Bell, 29 Jul 2026) [S112]	The FCA is examining how wealth firms profit from client cash. Rathbones stops charging fees on cash.	Consumer Duty in practice: "fair value" applies to everything.
More than 1,000 non-doms left before reform (The National, 31 Jul 2026) [S149]	HMRC data on wealthy foreign-domiciled residents leaving.	A UK-rooted client base is less exposed than London-international banks Inferred .
FCA findings on Consumer Duty products and services (A&O Shearman, 10 Jul 2026) [S141]	Firms must show they adapt products for vulnerable customers, not just describe processes.	Relevant for older and rural clients.
UK financial services M&A up eight-fold (WealthBriefing, 7 Jul 2026) [S159]	EY data: technology and AI are the top reason for deals.	Should a small bank build, buy or partner for technology? (Weatherbys partners: Saxo.)

Reading list to follow weekly

WealthBriefing (private banking trade news); TheWealthNet / PAM Insight; Citywire Wealth Manager; Bank of England Monetary Policy Summaries; FT Money and Lex; Farmers Weekly (for APR/BPR); Racing Post business pages; Weatherbys' own "Insights" and press coverage pages ^[S25]. The companion file *Reading_List.md* has links.

PART 8

Forming your own view

Assessment centres reward a clear opinion held with reasons, and a willingness to see the other side. Here are five debates, with both sides.

Question	Case for	Case against
Can a small family bank survive consolidation?	Service gap as big banks standardise; NPS 84; Coutts bankers choosing it; strong capital ^{[S4][S31]}	Technology and regulatory costs are fixed, so scale helps; ROE 8.9%; size ceiling of 15,000 relationships ^{[S4][S15]}
Is "100% human, 100% digital" realistic?	Clients want both; partner for platforms (Saxo); fintech board member hired ^{[S4][S15]}	Building digital banking is expensive and big banks spend far more; the new digital bank was only due in 2026
Are falling rates a threat?	87% of income is interest; underlying profit halved in 2025 ^[S4]	Lower rates help clients borrow, and the bank's loan book grew 16%; the rate debate now runs both ways ^[S102]
Was selling Hamilton right?	Focus on core banking and wealth; £10.2m gain ^[S4]	Loses an insurance link with bloodstock and private clients; less diversification
Will the APR/BPR cap help or hurt?	New advice and lending demand around succession ^[S152]	Some families may sell land or move assets; less wealth to bank over time

YOUR OPINION GOES HERE: A MODEL

"I think the boutique model is more durable than it looks, because the thing it sells, one person's judgement, is exactly what consolidation removes. The real risk is cost: if margins keep falling, Weatherbys has to grow advice income and lending faster than costs. The 30% growth in investment assets under advice is the number I'd watch." ^[S4]

PART 9

The assessment centre

Expected on Monday 30 November or Monday 7 December 2026. Its format is not published, so this part separates what is known from what is likely.

9.1 What is known and what is likely

Item	What we know	Confidence
Stages	Application form, then assessment centre on 30 Nov or 7 Dec 2026 (advert)	Confirmed
Weatherbys' process for experienced private bankers	Talent Acquisition call, then a conversation with a senior banker, then a "technical or case-based discussion" on "lending, client scenarios", then a final conversation with senior leadership ^[S9]	Confirmed (for experienced hires)
APB training uses role-plays	"Performing role play scenarios for lending and investment meetings with clients has really helped me get up to speed quickly" (Jack, APB) ^[S9]	Confirmed
Likely intern assessment centre content	A competency interview based on your form, a group exercise, and possibly a short client role-play or case discussion. Probably commercial awareness questions on the bank and the sector.	Inferred
Interview difficulty	Glassdoor search snippet: 2.9 out of 5 (all roles) ^[S36]	Reported, anecdote

9.2 Question bank (44 questions)

Scaffolds, not scripts. Each row gives what is really being tested, a structure, the facts to weave in and the trap. The same bank is in *Question_Bank.md* for practice.

#	Question	Really testing	Structure	Facts to weave in	Trap
1	Why private banking? Motivation	Do you know what the job is, and is your interest earned?	Moment → insight about the job → evidence you acted on it	One banker across lending, investments and banking ^[S9] ; 87% of income is interest ^[S4]	Describing investment banking or stock-picking
2	Why Weatherbys rather than Coutts or Hoare's? Motivation	Research depth; can you name a mechanism?	Two mechanisms + one live fact + one personal link	Human credit decisions ^[S17] ; NPS 84 ^[S4] ; Coutts hires moving to Weatherbys ^[S31]	Running down a rival
3	What do you know about our history? Motivation	Did you go beyond the homepage?	1770 stakeholder → 1994 licence → 2006 London → today	James Weatherby, Jockey Club, 1770; licence 1994 ^[S5] ^[S4]	Calling it the oldest bank in the UK
4	Where do you see yourself in five years? Motivation	Fit with the APB route; realism	APB → qualified → building own client book	APB is two years to Private Banker ^[S9] ; CeMAP, IAD, PCIAM ^[S9]	Saying you want to move to investment banking
5	What would you want to get out of the internship? Motivation	Self-awareness; will you add value?	Learn X, contribute Y, test Z about yourself	Live projects; exposure across the bank [advert]	Only talking about what you get

6	Which of our client segments interests you most and why? Motivation	Genuine curiosity about clients	Pick one; name their need; name the bank's answer	Farms and estates + APR/BPR cap ^{[S19][S152]} ; sport + Wotton hire ^[S31]	Picking one you know nothing about
7	How does a private bank make money? Commercial	Basic business literacy	Deposits → lending and liquidity → margin + fees → costs → profit	NII £79.0m of £91.1m income; NIM 4.05% ^[S4]	Saying 'fees from investments' only
8	Why did our profit fall in 2025? Commercial	Did you read the annual report?	Rates fell → margin squeezed; costs up for growth; one-off gain	PBT £12.8m vs £26.7m pre one-offs; costs +19% ^[S4]	Sounding critical; be neutral and factual
9	What is the biggest challenge facing private banks? Commercial	Can you form and defend a view?	Name one, two pieces of evidence, the other side, your view	Consolidation ^[S159] ; rates ^[S102] ; tax changes ^[S152]	Listing five challenges with no view
10	How do interest rate changes affect us? Commercial	Mechanism understanding	Deposit margin vs borrower demand vs credit risk	LDR 53%; ~£996m liquidity ^[S4] ; Bank Rate 3.75% ^[S102]	Saying higher rates are simply good
11	Tell me about a recent news story in wealth management. Commercial	Do you follow the sector?	What happened → why it matters → what it means for us	Any from Part 7	Choosing a story with no link to private banking
12	What do you think of the inheritance tax changes for farms? Commercial	Client empathy plus technical accuracy	Facts → impact on a family → banker's role → limits of role	£2.5m per person from 6 Apr 2026, 20% effective above ^[S152]	Giving political opinions or tax advice
13	Should a small bank build or buy its technology? Commercial	Judgement under trade-offs	Build for differentiation, partner for commodity; example	Saxo partnership ^[S4] ; tech spend over £8m ^[S4]	Absolute answers
14	What is Consumer Duty? Commercial	Regulatory awareness	Date, principle, four outcomes, one practical example	31 Jul 2023; good outcomes for retail customers ^[S140]	Confusing it with FSCS
15	Why does the FSCS limit matter to our clients? Commercial	Joining regulation to client reality	Limit → HNW balances above it → bank strength matters	£120k from 1 Dec 2025; £1.4m temporary ^[S145] ; LCR 1,080% ^[S4]	Getting the limit wrong (£85k is old)
16	How would you grow the bank's client base? Commercial	Commercial creativity with judgement	Introducers, existing-client referrals, segments, events	Lombard for external portfolios ^[S27] ; Business Bank ^[S4]	Proposing mass marketing
17	Why did we launch a Business Bank? Commercial	Strategic reasoning	Client need → fit with existing model → risk → growth	Launched Q4 2025 for owner-managed and specialist businesses ^[S4]	Saying it is just about size
18	Tell me about a time you built a strong relationship. Relationships	Core competency (your form answer)	Gap → three actions → proof → lesson	Your Q2 answer; be ready for three levels of follow-up	Telling a different story from the form
19	Tell me about a time you dealt with a difficult person. Relationships	Composure, empathy	Understand their view → act → outcome → what you'd repeat	'Straightforward' and 'Trusted' values ^[S4]	Blaming the other person
20	How would you build trust with a client much older than you? Relationships	Self-awareness about age gap	Preparation, listening, reliability, honesty about limits	Named banker + assistant model ^[S16]	Pretending to be an expert

21	Tell me about a time you had to deliver bad news. Relationships	Honesty under pressure	Early, clear, with alternatives, followed up	Brand value 'Straightforward' [S4]	A story where you avoided it
22	How do you remember details about people? Relationships	Practical habit behind relationship skill	A concrete system you use	'Banking that knows you' [S16]	Saying 'I just have a good memory'
23	Tell me about a time you persuaded someone. Relationships	Influence without authority	Their interests → evidence → concession → agreement	Business development 'in a relationship-led way' [S9]	Pressure tactics
24	Tell me about a time you worked in a team. Teamwork	Collaboration and your specific role	Role → contribution → conflict handled → result	Culture 'collaborative, high-trust' [S9]	'We' with no 'I'
25	Tell me about a disagreement in a team. Teamwork	Constructive conflict	Issue → how you raised it - > resolution → relationship after	-	Showing you were simply right
26	What role do you usually take in a group? Teamwork	Self-awareness	Natural role + when you adapt	-	Always 'the leader'
27	Tell me about something you started. Initiative	Initiative (advert criterion)	Gap you saw → what you did → obstacles → result	Your Q3 answer	Something you were assigned
28	Tell me about a time you went beyond what was asked. Initiative	Work ethic	Expected → what you added → why → effect	-	Overclaiming impact
29	Tell me about a time you failed. Initiative	Honesty, learning	Real failure → your part → fix → what changed	-	A fake failure ('I work too hard')
30	How do you manage competing deadlines? Initiative	Organisation	System + example + result	-	No example
31	What does integrity mean to you? Values	Values fit	Definition → example where it cost you something	'We always act with integrity and do the right thing' [S4]	Abstract answer with no story
32	What would you do if a client offered you an expensive gift? Values	Conduct awareness	Thank, do not accept on the spot, declare, follow policy	Conflicts and gifts policy (standard)	Accepting or refusing rudely
33	What would you do if you saw a colleague breaking a rule? Values	Speak-up culture	Check facts → raise with them or manager → escalate if needed	-	'Not my business'
34	Which of our values resonates with you? Values	Did you read the values?	Pick one, story, why it matters in banking	Forward-looking, Individual, Responsive, Straightforward, Trusted [S4]	Listing all five
35	A farming client says they may need to sell land to pay inheritance tax. What do you do? Case	Client empathy, role boundaries, lending instinct	Listen → understand estate → bring in tax adviser and lawyer → options incl. lending	APR/BPR cap [S152], Senior Tax Adviser [S13]	Giving tax advice yourself
36	A client wants a mortgage but has irregular income. How would you think about it? Case	Credit judgement basics	Income history, assets, LTV, purpose, repayment source	Human underwriting for complex income [S17], ~34% LTV [S4]	Saying yes or no immediately

37	A client wants to borrow against their investment portfolio held elsewhere. Case	Product awareness	Lombard basics: LTV limit, volatility, purpose	Up to 50% LTV; external portfolios from Aug 2026 [S18][S27]	Ignoring market risk
38	A long-standing client complains about a mistake by the bank. Case	Service recovery	Apologise, own, fix, follow up, learn	NPS 84 [S4]	Defending the bank first
39	You notice a large unexplained deposit into a client's account. Case	AML instinct	Do not tip off; record; escalate to compliance	KYC/AML	Asking the client directly
40	Two senior bankers both want your help with urgent work today. Case	Prioritisation and communication	Clarify deadlines → tell both → agree order → deliver	-	Saying yes to both and failing one
41	Sell me this pen. Curveball	Questions before pitching	Ask about needs first, then link features to them	Relationship-led selling [S9]	Launching into features
42	What would you change about Weatherbys? Curveball	Constructive critique	Respectful observation + evidence + idea	Digital rollout; regional growth [S4]	Harsh criticism or 'nothing'
43	Tell me something not on your CV. Curveball	Personality, conversation skill	One genuine interest with a short story	-	A rehearsed brag
44	Do you follow horse racing? Curveball	Honesty	Honest answer + what you know about the Racing Bank	Racing Bank products [S21]; Super Sprint since 1993 [S23]	Pretending

9.3 Questions you should ask (only someone who did the research could ask these)

1. "Since the APR and BPR cap came in last April, how have conversations with farming and landed clients changed? Is it more lending, or more coordination with their advisers?"
2. "The CEO has talked about a ceiling of 10,000 to 15,000 relationships for staying flexible. How do you think about where the bank is against that?"
3. "Lombard lending now works against portfolios held elsewhere. Has that changed how bankers win new clients?"
4. "How does the Business Bank work with the Private Bank? Do private clients' businesses move across?"
5. "With several senior hires from Coutts, what do they say is different here?"
6. "What separates an intern who goes on to the APB programme from one who doesn't?"
7. "How is the new digital platform changing what a banker's assistant does day to day?"
8. "What does a good first year look like for a new Associate Private Banker in terms of qualifications?"
9. "If rates do rise again, as three MPC members voted for in September, how does that change the bank's priorities?"

PART 10

Interviewer briefing

No interviewers have been named. These are the senior people in Private Clients you are most likely to meet or hear from. Public professional information only.

Name	Role and public background	Type
Quentin Marshall	Group CEO since September 2023. Joined in 2015 from Coutts (Head of Advisory, Investments). 16 years at UBS / SG Warburg [S4][S8]	Practitioner, strategy-minded
Oliver Barnett	Head of Private Clients [S13]	Practitioner; likely senior sign-off
Duncan Gourlay	Deputy Head of Private Clients; quoted on the Manchester move: "Weatherbys' origins can be traced back to 1770, but we've always strived to move with the times" [S13][S19b]	Practitioner
Team leads	Simon Gardiner, Nick Manduca (London); Aidan Faik (farms and estates); Michelle Duncalf (Manchester, ex-Coutts) [S13][S20]	Practitioners; likely interviewers or assessors
Tom O'Reilly	HR Director (author of the 2025 gender pay gap report) [S34]	People function

SOURCE UNCERTAIN

Who sits on the intern assessment panel is not public. Names above are from the firm's own pages. Do not mention having researched an interviewer personally; mention the business facts instead.

Reading the interviewer live

- **Practitioner (a banker):** wants to know if clients would trust you. Talk about people, judgement and clients. Expect "what would you do" questions.
- **HR or talent:** marks against competencies. Use clear structure, "I" statements and results.
- **Senior leader:** wants to see curiosity and a view. Ask one of the questions in 9.3.

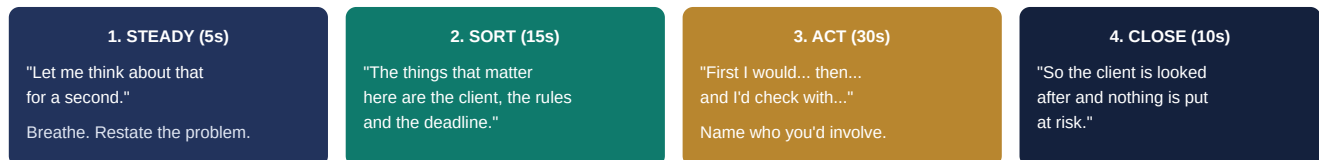
PART 11

The scenario playbook

How to answer any "what would you do" question, how to hold your ground when pushed, and three scenarios for each thing the advert asks for.

11.1 The four-step protocol: steady, sort, act, close

Fig 11.1 The four-step answer, 45 to 75 seconds



Author's method [Inferred]. Timing is a guide: long enough to show reasoning, short enough to leave room for the follow-up.

11.2 The priority order when good things collide

Fig 11.2 When priorities collide, take them in this order



The sentence that holds every frame: "I'd want to do this quickly, but not in a way that puts the client or the bank at risk."

11.3 Eight ways interviewers test your frame, and the counter

Tactic	What it looks like	Counter
Interruption	Cut off mid-answer	Stop, listen, answer the new point, then: "Coming back to what I was saying..."
Flat contradiction	"That's wrong."	"Can I ask which part? If I've missed something I'd like to understand it." Do not cave if your reasoning holds.
Silence	They say nothing after you finish	Do not keep talking. If it lasts, ask: "Would it help if I went into more detail on any part?"
Escalation	"And now the client threatens to leave."	Re-run the protocol. Your priority order does not change because the stakes rose.
Authority squeeze	"A senior banker tells you to skip it."	"I'd respect their judgement on the client, but I'd raise the check with them, or with compliance, before skipping it."
False choice	"Do you lose the client or break the rule?"	"I don't think those are the only options. I'd look for a third..."
Knowledge trap	A technical question you can't answer	"I don't know that yet. My understanding is X; I'd check it with Y."
Invitation to badmouth	"Isn't Coutts better for clients?"	"It suits some clients. What interests me here is..." Never criticise a rival or a former employer.

Staying calm physically: both feet on the floor, slow exhale before you answer, water on the table, and a pen in hand to note the question's parts.

11.4 The scenario ladder: three rungs for each thing the advert asks for

Fig 11.3 Six criteria from the advert, three difficulty rungs each (18 cards below)

Curiosity	Communication	Relationships	Collaboration	Initiative	Professionalism
Easy: everyday situation		Medium: competing pressures		Hard: a twist designed to break you	

Curiosity

Easy Your banker asks you to prepare a one-page brief on a new client, a family that owns a 600-acre farm.

Trap: Copying generic web text.

Say: Cover who they are, what they likely need (succession, lending against land, cash flow), the April 2026 relief cap, and three questions the banker could ask.

Why it works: Shows you think about the client's whole picture ^{[S9][S152]}.

Twist and hold: "You've got 30 minutes." Prioritise: needs and questions first, background last.

Medium In a team meeting a senior banker asks the interns what they've noticed so far.

Trap: Saying 'everyone's really nice'.

Say: One specific observation and one question, e.g. how bankers decide when to bring in IWA.

Why it works: Curiosity tied to the business model ^[S9].

Twist and hold: "Is that a criticism?" No: "It's something I'd like to understand."

Hard An interviewer asks: 'What's one thing about our business model you'd question?'

Trap: Either flattering or attacking.

Say: "87% of income is interest, so falling rates bite. I'd ask how fast advice income can grow to offset it."

Why it works: Evidence-based, respectful ^[S4].

Twist and hold: "So you think we're doing it wrong?" Hold: "No. The 30% growth in assets under advice suggests it's working. I'd watch it."

Communication

Easy Explain to a client's teenage child what a private bank does.

Trap: Jargon.

Say: "They look after a family's money: keeping it safe, lending when you need it, and helping it grow, through one person who knows you."

Why it works: Plain language is a core banker skill.

Twist and hold: "Now explain net interest margin." Use the shop analogy: buy money at one price, lend at a higher one.

Medium Your project findings are disappointing and you present to a team lead.

Trap: Burying the bad news.

Say: Lead with the finding, give the evidence, then the options.

Why it works: 'Straightforward' value ^[S4].

Twist and hold: They challenge your data. "Fair point; here's how I got it, and here's what would change my mind."

Hard Role-play: a client is angry about a delayed payment and talks over you.

Trap: Matching their tone or over-apologising.

Say: Let them finish, acknowledge, state what you'll do and by when, then follow up.

Why it works: Service recovery protects NPS ^[S4].

Twist and hold: "I want to speak to someone senior." "Of course. I'll arrange it today and make sure they have the full picture."

Relationships

Easy At a client event you are introduced to an elderly client.

Trap: Talking about yourself.

Say: Ask about them; remember a detail; pass it to the banker afterwards.

Why it works: 'Banking that knows you' ^[S16].

Twist and hold: They ask your view on the market. "I'm still learning. What's your view?"

Medium A client calls asking for their banker, who is away.

Trap: Promising something you can't deliver.

Say: Take full details, confirm when the banker or their assistant will call, log it, follow up.

Why it works: Named banker and assistant model ^[S16].

Twist and hold: "It's urgent." Escalate to the assistant or team lead now; don't improvise advice.

Hard A client you've built rapport with asks you, the intern, for investment advice.

Trap: Giving it to please them.

Say: "I can't advise, but I'll make sure the right person calls you today."

Why it works: Advice is regulated; Consumer Duty ^[S140].

Twist and hold: "Off the record?" "There isn't an off the record for me, but you'll get a proper answer quickly."

Collaboration

Easy Group exercise: a teammate is quiet.

Trap: Ignoring them to dominate.

Say: Invite them in: "What do you think?"

Why it works: Assessors score team behaviour, not airtime [Inferred].

Twist and hold: They disagree with you. Weigh it openly.

Medium Group exercise: two members argue and time is running out.**Trap:** Taking a side.**Say:** Summarise both positions, propose a decision rule (client impact), keep time.**Why it works:** Facilitation shows leadership without dominance.**Twist and hold:** Someone says "just pick one". Do so, with a reason.**Hard** Another intern takes credit for your idea in front of a senior banker.**Trap:** Confronting publicly.**Say:** Build on it publicly; raise it privately and calmly later if it matters.**Why it works:** Collaborative, high-trust culture ^[S9].**Twist and hold:** "Wasn't that your idea?" "We developed it together; I'm glad it's useful."**Initiative****Easy** You finish your project task early.**Trap:** Waiting to be told.**Say:** Offer help to your buddy or team; suggest a small useful add-on.**Why it works:** Advert: 'demonstrate initiative'.**Twist and hold:** "Nothing for you today." Ask to shadow a call or read a credit paper.**Medium** You spot a recurring inefficiency in a team process.**Trap:** Changing it yourself.**Say:** Note the evidence, suggest it to the owner with a fix.**Why it works:** Initiative within process.**Twist and hold:** "We've always done it that way." "Understood. Would it help if I tested it on one case?"**Hard** Asked: 'Pitch us one new idea for the bank.'**Trap:** A big idea with no link to clients.**Say:** One client segment, one need, one low-cost action, one measure of success.**Why it works:** e.g. succession briefings after APR/BPR change ^[S152].**Twist and hold:** "That already exists." "Then I'd ask how many clients have used it and why not more."**Professionalism****Easy** You are running late on the first day.**Trap:** Arriving without warning.**Say:** Call ahead, give a time, apologise briefly, make up the time.**Why it works:** Reliability is the base of trust.**Twist and hold:** It happens twice: own it and fix the cause.**Medium** A friend asks which famous clients the bank has.**Trap:** Hinting.**Say:** "I can't talk about clients at all."**Why it works:** Confidentiality.**Twist and hold:** "Just between us?" Same answer.

Hard A banker asks you to send a client document before the compliance check is done, because the client is pushing.

Trap: Sending it to please the banker.

Say: Raise it: "Shall I ask compliance if they can prioritise it?"

Why it works: Priority order: rules first [Fig 11.2].

Twist and hold: "Just send it." "I'm not comfortable without the check. Can we call compliance together?"

11.5 The composure set: five hard scenarios

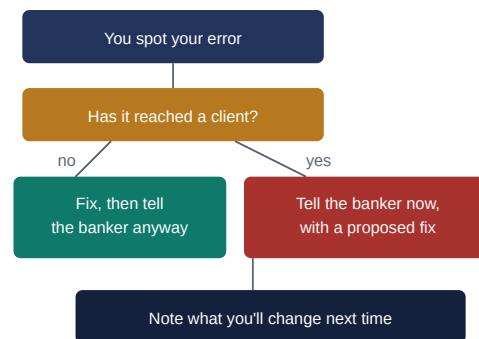
Scenario	Hold the frame like this
Two senior bankers want your time on urgent work at once	Do not choose silently. Tell both, give each the honest timing, and ask whoever allocates your work (your manager or buddy) to decide if needed. Deliver what you promised.
A senior person asks you to skip a check "just this once"	Respect, then rule: "I'm happy to help get it done fast. Could we check with compliance whether there's a quicker way, so neither of us is exposed?"
You overhear confidential client information	Keep it to yourself; do not write it down or repeat it; if it was clearly not meant for you, tell your manager discreetly.
You made a mistake in work a banker is about to send a client	Tell them immediately, with the fix ready. Speed of disclosure matters more than embarrassment.
Deadline today, information incomplete	Say what you know and what you don't, deliver the best version with the gaps flagged, and propose when you'll close them.

Fig 11.4 Two decision trees you can draw from memory

A. "Skip the control?"



B. "I made a mistake"



Author's method [Inferred], consistent with the bank's stated value "We always act with integrity and do the right thing" [S4].

11.6 The CV grill

Interviewers often go three levels deep on one line: **what** did you do, **why** did you do it that way, and **what would you do differently**. The goal is to see whether the story is really yours.

Attack	Frame-holding answer
"What exactly did you do?"	Separate your actions from the team's, with one concrete detail.
"That doesn't sound very impressive."	"It was a small role. What I learned was X, and I used it when..."
"Why did you stop?"	An honest reason without blame, and what you moved on to.
"What went wrong?"	A real problem, your part in it, the fix.
"Your grades dipped here."	Facts, no excuses, what changed after.

"How does this relate to banking?"	One transferable skill, linked to a banker's year-one success measures ^[S9] .
"Your form answer said X; tell me more."	Know every story in your form to three levels. Keep the same facts.
"Why should we pick you over someone with banking experience?"	"I don't have their experience. I've shown I build relationships that last, I've done the research, and I'm here to learn the Weatherbys way."

FOUR-LINE DRILL FOR EVERY CV BULLET

1. What happened, in one sentence.
2. My specific action and why.
3. The result, with a number if possible.
4. What I'd do differently, and what it taught me about working with people.

PART 12

"Why Weatherbys" in three lengths

Mechanism, not adjectives. Each version would need rewriting to work for any other bank.

Fig 12.1 "Why Weatherbys" on one page: four mechanisms leading to one personal reason



Sources as tagged. The synthesis is the author's [Inferred].

Thirty seconds

"Weatherbys is built so that the person who knows the client makes the decision: one banker covers lending, investments and banking, and credit decisions are made by people rather than scoring models. That's the job I want to learn. It's also growing while staying deliberately small enough to keep that flexibility, which means an intern is close to real work. And [personal link]."

Two minutes

Add to the thirty-second version: (1) one segment and a live issue, e.g. farms and estates and the April 2026 APR/BPR cap; (2) evidence that the model works, such as NPS 84 and Private Bank of the Year 2026; (3) evidence of momentum, such as experienced Coutts bankers joining, the Business Bank, and Lombard lending for external portfolios; (4) the APB route and the qualification you'd take.

The close: one specific thing you want to work on

"If I could pick one area, it would be [farms and estates / sport and entertainment / racing], because [reason linked to your own life], and because [the live issue: e.g. succession planning after the April 2026 changes] is where a banker who understands the whole family adds most."

What most candidates say versus what you can say

Most candidates	You
"A prestigious, historic bank"	"It started in 1770 as racing's stakeholder, the trusted keeper of other people's money. That is still the job."
"Excellent client service"	"An NPS of 84, and a CEO who caps growth at 10,000 to 15,000 relationships to protect it."
"Interested in wealth management"	"Investment assets under advice grew 30% last year, which matters because 87% of income is interest and rates fell."
"Great culture"	"Coutts bankers have joined for 'a more entrepreneurial environment'. I'd like to understand why."

The honest counter-case

- It is small: fewer resources and less brand recognition than Coutts or Barclays ^{[S103][S115]}.
- Return on equity is below its own aspiration ^[S4].
- It calls itself "quite traditional and hierarchical" ^[S15].
- The APB programme is a two-year fixed-term role, so a permanent job depends on qualifying ^[S24b].
- The gender pay gap is wide, and the bank acknowledges it ^[S34].

Knowing these makes your "why" more convincing, not less: you chose it with open eyes.

PART 13

Cheat sheet

One page. Also supplied separately as Cheat_Sheet.pdf.

The firm in five lines

- 1770 racing stakeholder; bank licence 1994; London 2006; family-owned, 7th generation ^{[S4][S5]}
- FY2025: deposits £1,905m, loans £1,006m, assets £2,053m, 483 staff ^[S4]
- 87% of income is interest; NIM 4.53% to 4.05%; PBT pre one-offs £26.7m to £12.8m ^[S4]
- NPS 84; CET1 13.1%; LCR 1,080%; LDR 53%; private LTV ~34% ^[S4]
- CEO Quentin Marshall (ex-Coutts); Chair Roger Weatherby; Head of Private Clients Oliver Barnett ^{[S4][S13]}

Recent moves

- Hamilton sold, Aug 2025; Business Bank, Q4 2025 ^[S4]
- Private Bank of the Year, 20 May 2026 ^[S26]
- Lombard on external portfolios, Aug 2026 ^[S27]
- Matt Wotton (ex-Coutts), Head of Sports, Media & Ent., 6 Oct 2026 ^[S31]

The sector in four dates

- Consumer Duty 31 Jul 2023 ^[S140]; FSCS £120k from 1 Dec 2025 ^[S145]
- APR/BPR £2.5m cap from 6 Apr 2026 ^[S152]
- Basel 3.1 + SDDT capital 1 Jan 2027 ^[S143]; pensions in IHT 6 Apr 2027 ^[S154]
- Bank Rate 3.75%, 6-3 hold on 17 Sep 2026; next 5 Nov ^[S102]

One question to ask

"Since the APR and BPR cap came in, how have conversations with farming clients changed?"

Answer protocol

Steady (restate) → **Sort** (client, rules, time) → **Act** (steps + who you'd involve) → **Close** (client safe, nothing at risk). 45 to 75 seconds.

Priority order

1 Rules and the bank's name → 2 Client's real interest → 3 Process and record → 4 Speed.

"Quickly, but not in a way that puts the client or the bank at risk."

Counters

- Interrupted: answer, then "coming back to..."
- Contradicted: "Which part?" Hold if reasoning holds.
- Silence: stop talking; offer more detail.
- False choice: look for the third option.
- Don't know: "My understanding is X; I'd check with Y."
- Badmouth bait: never criticise rivals.

Never

- Give advice or tax advice as an intern
- Skip a control to please a senior person
- Talk about clients outside work
- Claim Weatherbys is the oldest or biggest bank
- Fake a love of racing

Lines ready

- "Weatherbys is built so the person who knows the client makes the decision."
- "It's mostly a lending and deposit business wrapped in a relationship."
- "The growth in advice income is the number I'd watch."

PART 14

Glossary

Every technical term in the pack, in plain English.

AML	Anti-Money Laundering: rules and checks to stop criminal money entering the financial system.
APB	Associate Private Banker: Weatherbys' two-year graduate route to qualifying as a Private Banker ^[S9] .
APR	Agricultural Property Relief: inheritance tax relief on farmland and buildings, capped at £2.5m at 100% from 6 April 2026 ^[S152] .
Arkle Finance	Weatherbys' asset-finance subsidiary, 32% of group lending ^[S4] .
Asset finance	Loans to buy equipment or vehicles, secured on the asset.
AUM / AUMA	Assets under management (and administration): client investments a firm manages or holds.
Bank Rate	The Bank of England's main interest rate; 3.75% as of September 2026 ^[S102] .
Basel 3.1	The final stage of international bank capital rules, in the UK from 1 Jan 2027 ^[S146] .
Bloodstock	Thoroughbred horses bred for racing, and the business around them.
BPR	Business Property Relief: inheritance tax relief on family business assets, capped like APR from April 2026.
Bridging loan	A short-term loan covering a gap, such as buying before selling.
CeMAP	Certificate in Mortgage Advice and Practice, the standard UK mortgage adviser qualification.
CET1 ratio	Highest-quality capital as a share of risk-weighted assets; 13.1% at Weatherbys in 2025 ^[S4] .
Commercial awareness	Understanding how a business makes money and what affects it.
Consumer Duty	FCA rule from 31 July 2023 requiring good outcomes for retail customers ^[S140] .
Credit risk	The risk that a borrower does not repay.
Deposit	Money a client places with the bank, which the bank must repay.
Discretionary management	An investment manager makes decisions for the client within agreed limits.
Execution-only	The client makes their own investment decisions; the firm only carries out trades (Weatherbys via Saxo) ^[S4] .
FCA	Financial Conduct Authority: regulates how firms treat customers and markets.
FRN	Firm Reference Number on the FCA register; Weatherbys Bank is 204571 ^[S3] .
FSCS	Financial Services Compensation Scheme; protects deposits up to £120,000 from 1 Dec 2025 ^[S145] .
FX	Foreign exchange: converting one currency into another.
General Stud Book	The official record of thoroughbred pedigrees, kept by Weatherbys since 1791 ^[S5] .
HNW	High net worth: wealthy individuals, often defined as £1m+ of investable assets (definitions vary).
IAD	Investment Advice Diploma, a UK qualification for investment advisers.

IHT	Inheritance tax: tax on an estate when someone dies, usually 40% above allowances.
Impairment	Money set aside for expected loan losses; £4.6m at Weatherbys in 2025 ^[S4] .
Introducer	A professional (lawyer, accountant) who refers clients to a bank.
IWA	Investment & Wealth Advice, Weatherbys' in-house investment team ^[S9] .
KYC	Know Your Customer: verifying a client's identity and source of wealth.
LCR	Liquidity coverage ratio: liquid assets vs 30-day stress outflows; 1,080% at Weatherbys ^[S4] .
LDR	Loan-to-deposit ratio: loans divided by deposits; 53% at Weatherbys ^[S4] .
Leverage ratio	Capital divided by total exposures, unweighted; 6.05% at Weatherbys ^[S4] .
Liquidity	Assets that can be turned into cash quickly.
Lombard loan	A loan secured on an investment portfolio ^[S18] .
LTV	Loan-to-value: loan size divided by the value of the security.
Net interest income (NII)	Interest earned minus interest paid; £79.0m at Weatherbys in 2025 ^[S4] .
NIM	Net interest margin: NII as a share of interest-earning assets; 4.05% in 2025 ^[S4] .
Non-dom	A UK resident domiciled abroad; the special tax regime ended 6 April 2025 ^[S148] .
NPS	Net Promoter Score: % of promoters minus % of detractors; 84 at Weatherbys in 2025 ^[S4] .
PCIAM	Private Client Investment Advice & Management, a CISI qualification.
Pillar 3	Public disclosures a bank must make about its capital and risk ^[S22] .
PRA	Prudential Regulation Authority, part of the Bank of England; supervises banks' safety.
Private bank	A bank serving wealthy clients through named relationship managers.
Profit before tax (PBT)	Profit after all costs but before tax.
PSC	Person with significant control, recorded at Companies House.
Racing Bank	Weatherbys' banking service for the racing industry ^[S21] .
Relationship manager	Another name for a private banker: the client's main contact.
Retail customer	Under FCA rules, an individual rather than a professional client; includes most HNW individuals.
Return on equity (ROE)	Profit as a share of shareholders' funds; 8.9% at Weatherbys (operating, 2025) ^[S4] .
Risk-weighted assets	Assets adjusted for risk, used to set capital needs.
SDDT	Small Domestic Deposit Taker: the PRA's simpler regime; capital rules from 1 Jan 2027 ^[S143] .
Secured loan	A loan backed by an asset the lender can take if unpaid.
Source of wealth	How a client accumulated their wealth; a key KYC check.
STAR	Situation, Task, Action, Result: a structure for competency answers.
Succession planning	Planning how wealth or a business passes to the next generation.

Syndicate	A group of owners sharing a racehorse.
Total Capital Requirement	The capital the PRA requires a bank to hold; £60.5m for Weatherbys vs £105.5m held ^[S4] .
Treasury assets	Liquid assets a bank holds, such as reserves at the Bank of England; £996m at Weatherbys ^[S4] .
UHNW	Ultra-high net worth: very wealthy clients, often defined as \$30m+ (definitions vary).
Wealth management	Managing and planning a client's investments, usually for a percentage fee.
Weatherbys Ltd	The separate racing-services company (Stud Book, racing administration) under common control ^[S4] .

PART 15

Source table

Every [Sxx] tag in this pack. FETCHED = full page or PDF read; SNIPPET = search-result text only (lower confidence); summariser = read via a summary tool. All accessed 7 October 2026.

ID	Outlet	Title	Date	URL	Status	Note
S1	Wikipedia	Weatherbys	n/d	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Weatherbys	FETCHED	Medium; lists Ltd chair/CEO possibly outdated
S2	Companies House	Weatherbys Bank Limited 02943300 overview	live	https://find-and-update.company-information.service.gov.uk/company/02943300	FETCHED	High
S3	Weatherbys Bank	Corporate information	live	https://www.weatherbys.bank/?p=2268	FETCHED	High; links to AR 2025, Pillar 3 2024, GPG 2025
S4	Weatherbys Banking Group	Annual Report and Financial Accounts 2025	21 Apr 2026 (signed)	https://www.weatherbys.bank/app/uploads/2026/05/Weatherbys-Banking-Group-Annual-report-2025.pdf	FETCHED	High; full PDF text read
S5	Weatherbys Bank	Our history	live	https://www.weatherbys.bank/about-us/our-history/	FETCHED	High; date-event pairing inferred from order
S6	Companies House	Weatherbys Bank Ltd PSC	live	https://find-and-update.company-information.service.gov.uk/company/02943300/persons-with-significant-control	FETCHED	High
S7	Companies House	Weatherbys Bank Holdings Ltd (05659237) PSC	live	https://find-and-update.company-information.service.gov.uk/company/05659237/persons-with-significant-control	FETCHED	High
S8	The Intermediary	Quentin Marshall takes over as CEO at Weatherbys Banking Group	1 Sep 2023	https://theintermediary.co.uk/?p=31588	FETCHED	High
S9	Weatherbys Bank	Careers across the group (incl. early careers, FAQs)	live	https://www.weatherbys.bank/careers-at-weatherbys-banking-group/careers-across-the-group/	FETCHED	High; raw HTML read
S10	Weatherbys Bank	Weatherbys has agreed to sell its insurance arm as part of strategic move	c. Jul 2025	https://www.weatherbys.bank/?p=16282	FETCHED	High (summariser)
S11	Insurance Edge	Brown & Brown to acquire leading Private Client & Bloodstock broker Weatherbys Hamilton	24 Jul 2025	https://insurance-edge.net/2025/07/24/brown-brown-to-acquire-leading-private-client-bloodstock-broker-weatherbys-hamilton/	SNIPPET	Medium
S12	Mortgage Introducer (mpamag)	Weatherbys Banking Group announces new chairman	2023	https://www.mpamag.com/uk/mortgage-industry/growth/weatherbys-banking-group-announces-new-chairman/447257	SNIPPET	Medium; Bellamy six years to Mar 2024
S13	Weatherbys Bank	Our team	live	https://www.weatherbys.bank/about-us/team/	FETCHED	High; raw HTML read
S14	Weatherbys Bank	Careers (Working at Weatherbys)	live	https://www.weatherbys.bank/about-us/careers/	FETCHED	Medium (summariser)
S15	WealthBriefing	EXCLUSIVE: UK's Weatherbys Appoints Fintech Expert; Explains Private Bank Strategy	30 Jan 2026	https://www.wealthbriefing.com/html/article.php/exclusive%3A-uk%27s-weatherbys-appoints-fintech-expert%3B-explains-private-bank-strategy	FETCHED	High; raw HTML read, quotes verbatim
S16	Weatherbys Bank	Weatherbys Private Bank	live	https://weatherbys.bank/private-bank/	FETCHED	Medium (summariser)

S17	Weatherbys Bank	Lending and mortgages	live	https://www.weatherbys.bank/private-bank/private-banking/lending-mortgages/	FETCHED	Medium (summariser)
S18	Weatherbys Bank	Lombard lending	live	https://www.weatherbys.bank/weatherbys-private-bank-lombard-lending/	SNIPPET	Medium; rate may change
S19	Weatherbys Bank	Farms and estates	live	https://www.weatherbys.bank/private-bank/specialist-banking/farms-and-estates/	FETCHED	Medium (summariser)
S19b	Weatherbys Bank	A new Manchester home for Weatherbys Private Bank	c. Aug 2026	https://www.weatherbys.bank/?p=19550	FETCHED	Medium (summariser)
S20	Weatherbys Bank	Weatherbys appoints former head of Coutts Manchester and former Coutts CEO to its Board	c. Jul 2025	https://www.weatherbys.bank/insights/weatherbys-appoints-former-head-of-coutts-manchester-office-and-welcomes-former-coutts-ceo-to-its-board/	FETCHED	Medium (summariser)
S21	Weatherbys Bank	Racing professionals	live	https://www.weatherbys.bank/private-bank/specialist-banking/racing-professionals/	FETCHED	Medium (summariser)
S22	Weatherbys Bank	Pillar 3 Disclosures 2024	Apr 2025	http://www.weatherbys.bank/app/uploads/2025/04/Weatherbys-Bank-Pillar-3-Disclosures-2024.pdf	FETCHED	High; PDF text grepped
S23	Thoroughbred Daily News	Weatherbys Extends Sponsorship Of Super Sprint At Newbury	24 Jan 2025	https://www.thoroughbreddailynews.com/weatherbys-extends-sponsorship-of-super-sprint-at-newbury/	FETCHED	High (summariser)
S24	Workable	Senior Private Banker (London)	26 Jun 2026	https://jobs.workable.com/jobs/b6c8b519-bdec-4439-9c91-3b6cf6abb914.md	FETCHED	Medium; "100+ clients" from search snippet only
S24b	Workable (search results)	APB (2-year Fixed Term Programme); Summer Internship Programme 2025; PB Associate/Executive	various	https://apply.workable.com/weatherbys-bank/j/8016587D4D : .../j/516E37598D	SNIPPET	Low-medium; postings closed/JS-only
S25	Weatherbys Bank	Press coverage	live	https://www.weatherbys.bank/insights/press-coverage/	FETCHED	High for headlines and dates only
S26	Citywealth	Citywealth Magic Circle Awards marks 21st year...	20 May 2026	https://www.citywealthmag.com/news/citywealth-magic-circle-awards-marks-21st-year-with-10000-raised-for-magic-breakfast/	FETCHED	High (summariser)
S27	TheWealthNet (PAM Insight)	Weatherbys expands Lombard lending capabilities	25 Aug 2026	https://www.paminsight.com/twn/article/weatherbys-expands-lombard-lending-capabilities	FETCHED	Medium; related headlines only
S28	TDN	O'Regan Appointed CEO of Weatherbys as Ferris Joins RMG	2 Apr 2025	https://wp.tdn.pmadv.com/?p=462726	FETCHED	High
S29	TrueNicks	O'Regan to Succeed Ferris as CEO of Weatherbys Limited	2025	https://truenicks.com/articles/283582/o-regan-to-succeed-ferris-as-ceo-of-weatherbys-limited/print	FETCHED	High
S30	TDN	Weatherbys and British Racing School join forces...	15 Sep 2026	https://www.thoroughbreddailynews.com/weatherbys-and-british-racing-school-join-forces-to-help-racings-next-generation/	FETCHED	High (summariser)
S31	WealthBriefing	Weatherbys recruits ex-Coutts figure to head sports, media and entertainment arm	6 Oct 2026	https://www.wealthbriefing.com/html/article.php/weatherbys-recruits-ex_dash_coutts-figure-to-head-sports%2C-media-and-entertainment-arm	FETCHED	High (summariser)
S32	Financial Ombudsman Service	DRN-4775803	n/d	https://www.financial-ombudsman.org.uk/decision/DRN-4775803.pdf	SNIPPET	Low; not read

S3 3	Weatherbys Bank / misc.	Events; Silver Compassionate Employers Award (search summary)	2026	https://www.weatherbys.bank/insights/private-bank-events/	SNIPPET	Low
S3 4	Weatherbys Bank	Gender Pay Gap Report 2025	1 Mar 2026	http://www.weatherbys.bank/app/uploads/2026/06/Weatherbys-Bank-Ltd-Gender-Pay-Gap-Report-2025.pdf	FETCHED	High
S3 5	Weatherbys Bank	Search and apply (live vacancies)	live	https://www.weatherbys.bank/careers-at-weatherbys-banking-group/search-and-apply/	FETCHED	High; raw HTML read
S3 5b	Workable	Weatherbys Banking Group careers page	live	https://apply.workable.com/weatherbys-bank/	FETCHED	Blurb only (JS app); API blocked by Cloudflare 1015
S3 6	Glassdoor	Weatherbys Bank reviews	n/d	https://www.glassdoor.com/Overview/XT-ELIE3219205.htm	SNIPPET	Low; anecdote, not fetched
S3 7	Racing Post	Ex-ATR and Limerick boss Russell Ferris made chief executive of Weatherbys	n/d	https://racingpost.com/bloodstock/news/ex-atr-and-limerick-boss-russell-ferris-made-new-chief-executive-of-weatherbys-aMSpe5R3lInnX	SNIPPET	Medium
S3 8	WealthBriefing	Today It's Much More Than Horse Racing That Drives Private Banking At Weatherbys	n/d	https://www.wealthbriefing.com/html/article.php/Today-It's-Much-More-Than-Horse-Racing-That-Drives-Private-Banking-At-Weatherbys	SNIPPET	Medium; licence in 1990s
S1 01	Bank of England	Interest rates and Bank Rate	live page (2026)	https://www.bankofengland.co.uk/money-policy/the-interest-rate-bank-rate	FETCHED	High. Primary source
S1 02	Bank of England	Bank rate maintained at 3.75% – September 2026 Monetary Policy Summary and Minutes	17 Sep 2026	https://www.bankofengland.co.uk/money-policy-summary-and-minutes/2026/september-2026	FETCHED	High. Primary source
S1 03	NatWest Group (RNS via shareprices.com)	NatWest Group plc Interim Results 2026 Part 1	31 Jul 2026	https://shareprices.com/rns/natwest-group-plc-interim-results-2026-part-1-aoxw22m8vap63i1/	FETCHED (first 100k chars)	High. AUMA total of about £131bn comes from a search snippet (panabee); the +£72.1bn figure was fetched
S1 05	C. Hoare & Co	Financial Report 2025 (FY to 31 Mar 2025)	Jul 2025	https://www.hoaresbank.co.uk/files/2025-07/Financial_Report_2025.pdf	FETCHED (PDF extracted locally)	High. Primary source
S1 09	DirectorsTalk / HL (search snippet)	Arbuthnot Banking Group reports £11.0m first-half profit and raises dividend	Jul 2026	https://www.directorstalkinterviews.com/arbuthnot-banking-group-reports-11-0m-first-half-profit-and-raises-dividend/4121256979	SNIPPET (fetch returned 403)	Medium. Deposit growth given as +8% y/y here vs +4% at S110 (different base periods likely)
S11 0	joshthompson.co.uk	Arbuthnot Banking Group profits hold steady as client balances pass £10bn	Jul 2026	https://joshthompson.co.uk/investing/arbuthnot-banking-group-interim-results-2026/	FETCHED	Medium. Blog summarising RNS; primary is ABG Interim Report 2026 PDF (not read)
S11 2	AJ Bell (Alliance News)	Rathbones lowers fourth quarter margin view as deals with FCA review	29 Jul 2026	https://www.ajbell.co.uk/news/articles/rathbones-lowers-fourth-quarter-margin-view-deals-fca-review	FETCHED	High
S11 3	EWN	Investec declares another record dividend, aims to dramatically increase SA client base	21 May 2026	https://www.ewn.co.za/2026/05/21/investec-declares-another-record-dividend-aims-to-dramatically-increase-sa-client-base	FETCHED	Medium-high
S11 4	Kalkine / Investegate (search snippet)	Rathbones Group interim results 2026	Jul 2026	https://www.investegate.co.uk/announcement/rns/rathbones-group-rat/interim-results-2026/9692292	SNIPPET	Medium
S11 5	WealthBriefing	Attributable profit slips at Barclays' private bank, wealth arm in H1 2026	28 Jul 2026	https://www.wealthbriefing.com/html/article.php/attribution-profit-slips-at-barclays-private-bank-2C-wealth-arm-in-h1-2026-	FETCHED	High

S11 6	WealthBriefing	Full-year operating profit dips at Coutts; assets rise (FY2024)	Feb 2025	https://www.wealthbriefing.com/html/article.php/full_dash_year-operating-profit-dips-at-coutts%3B-assets-rise	FETCHED	Medium. Mixes Coutts and NatWest PB&WM labels (op profit £264m, income £969m, AUMA £48.9bn); deposits £42.4bn from snippet
S1 20	Wikipedia	Coutts	live	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Coutts	FETCHED	Medium. Tertiary source; use for founding and history only
S1 21	Wikipedia	C. Hoare & Co	live	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/C._Hoare_%26_Co	FETCHED	Medium
S1 22	Wikipedia	Arbuthnot Latham	live	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Arbuthnot_Latham	FETCHED	Medium
S1 23	Wikipedia	Child & Co.	live	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Child_%26_Co	FETCHED	Medium
S1 24	PAM Insight / thewealthnet	End of an epoch: NatWest prepares to close UK's oldest private bank	8 Jun 2022	https://www.paminsight.com/twn/article/end-epoch-natwest-prepares-close-uks-oldest-private-bank	FETCHED (partly paywalled)	Medium-high
S1 25	Private Banker International	UBP boosts UK presence with SG Kleinwort Hambros deal	1 Apr 2025	https://www.privatebankerinternational.com/news/ubp-boosts-uk-presence-with-sg-kleinwort-hambros-deal/	FETCHED	High
S1 26	Wikipedia	Hampden & Co.	live	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Hampden_%26_Co	FETCHED	Medium. States a rebrand to "Hampden Bank" in March 2024; the 2026 press uses "Hampden Bank", which is consistent
S1 27	Mortgage Solutions	Hampden Bank's lending rises to £640m in 2025	22 Apr 2026	https://www.mortgagesolutions.co.uk/mortgage-news/2026/04/22/hampden-banks-lending-rises-to-640m-in-2025/	SNIPPET	Medium
S1 28	Hampden Bank	Hampden Bank delivers strong first-half performance	Aug 2026	https://www.hampdenbank.com/latest/news/hampden-bank-delivers-strong-first-half-performance	FETCHED	High. Primary source
S1 29	Scottish Financial News	Hampden Bank profit jumps '91%' as first-half turnaround takes hold	10 Aug 2026	https://www.scottishfinancialnews.com/articles/hampden-bank-profit-jumps-91-as-first-half-turnaround-takes-hold	FETCHED	High
S1 31	Wikipedia	Rathbones Group	live	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Rathbones_Group	FETCHED	Medium
S1 32	Wikipedia	Close Brothers	live	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Close_Brothers	FETCHED	Medium
S1 33	City AM / AJ Bell (search snippet)	Close Brothers completes sale of asset management arm to Oaktree	28 Feb 2025	https://www.ajbell.co.uk/news/articles/close-brothers-completes-sale-asset-management-arm-oaktree	SNIPPET	Medium-high
S1 34	AJ Bell (search snippet)	Close Brothers expects to absorb £320 million motor finance hit	2026	https://www.ajbell.co.uk/news/articles/close-brothers-expects-absorb-ps320-million-motor-finance-hit	SNIPPET	Medium
S1 35	City AM (search snippet)	Bank of Cyprus offloads UK subsidiary for £103m to 'Cynergy' consortium	2018	https://cityam.com/?p=226701	SNIPPET	Medium
S1 36	Wikipedia	Brown Shipley	live	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Brown_Shipley	FETCHED	Medium. AUM figure dates from 2019
S1 37	Private Banker International (search snippet)	Butterfield wraps up wind down of UK private banking operations	2017	https://www.privatebankerinternational.com/news/butterfield-wraps-up-wind-down-of-uk-private-banking-operations-190117-5719878/	SNIPPET	Medium-high
S1 40	FCA (search snippet, incl. PS22/9)	PS22/9: A new Consumer Duty	Jul 2022	https://www.fca.org.uk/publications/policy-statements/ps22-9-new-consumer-duty	SNIPPET (FCA landing page fetched but dates not shown)	High. Dates are widely known and consistent

S1 41	A&O Shearman FinReg	UK FCA findings on approach to products and services Consumer Duty outcome	10 Jul 2026	https://finreg.aoshearman.com/puk-fca-findings-on-approach-to-products-and-services-consumer-duty-outcomep	FETCHED	High
S1 42	Forvis Mazars / Regulation Tomorrow (snippet)	Key observations on PRA's Strong and Simple policy statement (PS15/23)	Dec 2023	https://www.regulationtomorrow.com/2023/12/pra-policy-statement-on-the-strong-and-simple-framework-scope-criteria-liquidity-and-disclosure-requirements/	SNIPPET	High
S1 43	Bank of England / PRA	PS4/26 – The Strong and Simple Framework: final policy statement	20 Jan 2026	https://www.bankofengland.co.uk/prudential-regulation/publication/2026/january/the-strong-and-simple-framework-final-policy-statement	FETCHED	High. Primary source
S1 44	PRA Rulebook (snippet)	SDDT Regime – General Application	2026	https://www.prarulebook.co.uk/prarules/sddt-regime--general-application	SNIPPET	Medium-high
S1 45	FSCS / Financial Reporter (snippet)	Deposit limit increase	Nov– Dec 2025	https://www.fscs.org.uk/what-we-cover/banks-building-societies-credit-unions/deposit-limit-increase/	SNIPPET	High. Consistent across several sources
S1 46	Bank of England (snippet)	The PRA announces a delay to the implementation of Basel 3.1	Jan 2025	https://www.bankofengland.co.uk/news/2025/january/the-pra-announces-a-delay-to-the-implementation-of-basel-3-1	SNIPPET	High
S1 47	Regulation Tomorrow / PwC (snippet)	Implementation of Basel 3.1: PRA publishes final rules	Jan 2026	https://www.regulationtomorrow.com/2026/01/implementation-of-basel-3-1-pra-publishes-final-rules/	SNIPPET	Medium-high
S1 48	Various (snippet)	UK scraps non-dom regime	2025	https://boldergroup.com/news/uk-scraps-non-dom-tax-regime/	SNIPPET	High (date widely known)
S1 49	The National	More than 1,000 non- doms left UK before tax reform took effect	31 Jul 2026	https://www.thenationalnews.com/business/money/2026/07/31/more-than-1000-non-doms-left-uk-before-tax-reform-took-effect/	FETCHED	Medium-high. Cites HMRC; check against the HMRC release if quoting
S1 50	WealthBriefing	Exclusive: UK's Weatherbys appoints fintech expert; explains private bank strategy	30 Jan 2026	https://www.wealthbriefing.com/html/article.php/exclusive%3A-uk%27s-weatherbys-appoints-fintech-expert%3B-explains-private-bank-strategy	FETCHED	High. NPS 81 vs 30 comes from a snippet
S1 51	Weatherbys	Weatherbys named Private Bank of the Year at the Citywealth Magic Circle Awards 2026	2026	https://www.weatherbys.bank/?p=18583	SNIPPET	Medium-high
S1 52	ATT (Chartered Institute of Taxation's ATT)	Government announces changes to new APR/BPR restrictions from 6 April 2026	23 Dec 2025	https://www.att.org.uk/technical/news/government-announces-changes-new-aprbpr-restrictions-6-april-2026	FETCHED	High
S1 53	Price Bailey / Penningtons (snippet)	Changes to APR and BPR	2026	https://www.penningtonslaw.com/insights/major-ihl-revision-government-raises-apr-bpr-cap-after-pushback/	SNIPPET	High (50% relief / 20% effective rate)
S1 54	Addleshaw Goddard / Royal London (snippet)	Finance Bill containing inheritance tax changes published	2 Mar 2026	https://www.addleshawgoddard.com/en/insights/insights-briefings/2026/pensions/trustee-quarterly-update-march-2026/finance-bill-containing-inheritance-tax-changes-published/	SNIPPET	High
S1 55	Morningstar / moneytothmass es (snippet)	Bank of England cuts UK interest rates to 3.75%	Dec 2025	https://global.morningstar.com/en-gb/economy/bank-england-cuts-uk-interest-rates-375	SNIPPET	High (consistent with S105 and S110)
S1 56	Brodies (snippet)	FCA's targeted support regime	2026	https://brodies.com/insights/pensions/fcas-targeted-support-regime/	SNIPPET	Medium-high
S1 57	Bank of England (snippet)	Record of the FPC meeting on 25 September 2026	Sep/Oct 2026	https://www.bankofengland.co.uk/-/media/boe/files/financial-policy-committee-record/2026/fpc-summary-and-record-september-2026	SNIPPET	Medium-high

S1 58	Financial Planning Today (snippet)	Two thirds of advisers unprepared for £5.5trn wealth transfer	c.2023	https://financialplanningtoday.co.uk/news/two-thirds-of-advisers-unprepared-for-5-5trn-wealth-transfer	SNIPPET	Medium. King's Court Trust estimate; date not confirmed
S1 59	WealthBriefing	UK Financial Services M&A Value Surged Eight-Fold In H1	7 Jul 2026	https://www.wealthbriefing.com/html/printarticle.php?id=208165	FETCHED	High (EY data)
S1 60	Private Banker International	Q&A with L.E.K. Consulting	15 Dec 2025	https://www.privatebankerinternational.com/features/qa-with-l-e-k-consulting/	FETCHED	High
S1 61	Funds Society	United Kingdom faces largest wealth exodus in a decade	19 Nov 2025	https://www.fundsociety.com/en/news/private-banking/united-kingdom-faces-largest-wealth-exodus-in-a-decade/	FETCHED	Medium. Henley projections are contested
S1 62	Mappr (snippet)	Where the World's Millionaires Are Moving in 2026	2026	https://www.mappr.co/where-millionaires-are-moving/	SNIPPET	Low. Repeats the 16,500 figure for 2026, which may be a mix-up with 2025
S1 63	Yahoo Finance / Infosys BPM (snippet)	Private banking vs wealth management; Retail banking vs wealth management	various	https://finance.yahoo.com/personal-finance/banking/comparison/private-banking-vs-wealth-management-204043752.html	SNIPPET	Medium. US-leaning definitions
S1 64	CFA Institute careers / job ads (snippet)	Private Banking Relationship Manager job descriptions	various	https://careers.cfainstitute.org/job/9000531/private-banking-relationship-manager/	SNIPPET	Low-medium. Generic, not UK-specific
S1 65	Edinburgh News (snippet)	Edinburgh private bank Hampden & Co cashes in on Adam & Co changes as deposits jump	c.2021	https://www.edinburghnews.scotsman.com/business/edinburgh-private-bank-hampden-co-cashes-in-on-adam-co-changes-as-deposits-jump-3216583	SNIPPET	Medium. Headline only
S1 66	Financial Reporter / Spear's (snippet)	NatWest Group acquires Evelyn Partners in £2.7bn deal	2026 (announcement)	https://www.financialreporter.co.uk/natwest-group-acquires-evelyn-partners-in-27bn-deal.html	SNIPPET	High (completion confirmed by S103)
S1 67	Advisor.ca	Canaccord to buy U.K. wealth manager with £3.1B in AUM	19 Aug 2026	https://www.advisor.ca/industry-news/industry/canaccord-to-buy-u-k-wealth-manager-with-3-1b-in-aum/	FETCHED	High
S1 68	Bright Network / Gradcracker (snippet)	Coutts Relationship Management internship / Insight Experience	2025–26	https://www.brightnetwork.co.uk/graduate-jobs/natwest-group/insight-experience-for-black-heritage-talent-coutts-relationship-management-2026	SNIPPET (full fetch 403)	Medium
S1 69	Bright Network (snippet)	C. Hoare & Co Graduate Programme	2022–23 listing	https://brightnetwork.co.uk/graduate-employer-company/c-hoare-co	SNIPPET	Medium. May be outdated
S17 0	Arbuthnot Latham careers (snippet)	Early careers / Graduate Programme 2026	2025–26	https://careers.arbuthnotlatham.co.uk/working-for-us/early-careers.aspx	SNIPPET	Medium-high
S17 1	ISE (snippet)	Student Recruitment Survey 2025	2025	https://ise.org.uk/_userfiles/pages/files/reports/student_recruitment_survey_2025.pdf	SNIPPET	Medium. 140 per vacancy figure not read in the PDF
S17 2	FE News	Half of employers concerned student use of AI is misrepresenting skills (ISE Student Development Survey 2025)	9 May 2025	https://www.fenews.co.uk/?p=505182	FETCHED	High
S17 3	COPFS (Crown Office & Procurator Fiscal Service)	How your application is assessed – Success Profiles	live	https://www.copfs.gov.uk/about-copfs/careers/how-your-application-is-assessed-success-profiles	FETCHED	High (public-sector rubric; illustrative for banks)
S17 4	Salford / Dundee university careers (snippet)	Application forms guidance	various	https://www.salford.ac.uk/careers/cvs-applications-and-interviews/application-forms	SNIPPET	Medium

S17	University of	STAR technique for	n.d.	https://www.reading.ac.uk/essentials/-/media/essentials/files/careers/careers-help-and-support-guides/applications-interviews-and-cvs/careers-star-technique-for-applications-and-interviews.pdf	SNIPPET	Medium
5	Reading Careers (snippet; PDF fetch unreadable)	applications and interviews				

PART 16

Gaps, open questions and self-check

What could not be established, so you never state it as fact.

16.1 What could not be found

- **The application form's weighting and the assessment centre format.** Neither is published. Part A's split and Part 9's format are inferences.
- **The 2027 internship's live Workable posting and other Weatherbys job adverts.** The site blocked automated reading, so older postings that would show team structure could not be read. The advert text you supplied was used verbatim.
- **Intern and APB cohort sizes, and APB salary.** Only "five new Associate Private Bankers" joined in 2025 ^[S4].
- **Minimum criteria to become a client.** Not published ^[S16].
- **Client numbers.** "22,000 clients" comes from a trade article citing the 2024 annual report, which was not read directly ^[S15].
- **A dedicated bloodstock-lending product.** No evidence found; do not claim one.
- **Exact London addresses.** The move to Shaftesbury Avenue and the Sackville Street "shop window" are confirmed ^[S4]; street numbers are not.
- **Whether Weatherbys uses the PRA's simpler SDDT regime.** Not verified.
- **2025 Pillar 3.** Not yet on the website as of 7 October 2026; the 2024 version was used ^[S22].
- **Glassdoor ratings.** From a search snippet only ^[S36].
- **Interviewer names.** None supplied; Part 10 lists likely senior people only.
- **Your CV.** Not supplied, so Part A's drafts contain placeholders.
- **UK politics.** One July 2026 article refers to "former PM Keir Starmer". This was not verified and the pack does not rely on it. Check current government before discussing tax policy.

16.2 Open questions worth asking at the assessment centre

Where are interns placed (London only, or also Wellingborough or Edinburgh as in 2025 ^[S24b])? What is the end-of-internship assessment? How many APB places are expected for 2028?

16.3 Self-check

Check	Status
Every figure has a source and date; estimates are labelled on charts	Done. One balancing figure in Fig 2.3 is labelled as inferred.
A beginner could read Parts 1, 2 and 5 without another source	Done; terms defined inline and in the glossary (63 terms).
"Why Weatherbys" is mechanism, not adjectives, and not transplantable	Done (Part 12, Fig 12.1).
Regulation section is current and dated	Done as of 7 Oct 2026 (Part 6).
Team section goes beyond the advert, with method shown and thin evidence admitted	Done (Section 1.6); headcount is an inferred range.

Three scenarios per advert criterion; composure set with decision trees	Done: 18 cards across six criteria, five composure scenarios, two trees. The advert lists experiences rather than duties, so its six "What we're looking for" criteria were used as the duty lines.
People sections contain only public professional information	Done.
PDF rendered, contents page numbers correct, figures checked for clipping	Done by two-pass render and page rasterisation (see build notes).
Diagram count	Fewer than the 33 in the original template. The priority was the application form, so diagrams that would have repeated the same data were dropped. Each figure carries its sources.